

KUTUMBA

Families Growing in Kṛṣṇa Consciousness

First Six-Month Detailed Curriculum

Cycles 1–3 | 18 Active Friday Sessions

Working Draft v0.9 | June 2026

Governance status

This is a detailed curriculum working draft for review by the KUTUMBA Curriculum and Philosophy Lead, Children and Safety Lead, Kīrtana and Worship Lead, Temple Liaison, and qualified ISKCON authorities where required. It is not an official ISKCON publication, an accredited Bhakti Śāstrī course, an initiation qualification, or authorization to independently change worship standards.

1. How to Use This Curriculum

This volume converts the approved first-six-month architecture into complete active-week lesson packs. Each cycle contains five instructional/application weeks, one integration week and one protected off week. The off week has no KUTUMBA meeting, make-up class or assignment chase.

Core implementation rule

Teach one clear principle, give families one usable method, and end with one realistic home commitment. Do not add extra philosophy merely because a facilitator knows it.

2. Assumptions and Boundaries

- Founding cohort: approximately five to six families, generally 20–25 participants.
- Friday program: 6:15–9:00 p.m.; formal devotional session 6:30–9:00 p.m.
- Child bands: Bāla I ages 4–6, Bāla II ages 7–9, and Kīśora ages 10–13. Older teens may join the parent track or supervised service roles.
- Primary doctrinal authority: Śrīla Prabhupāda's books and authorized ISKCON standards. Supplementary material requires review.
- Exact āratī, mantra, bhoga-offering and Deity-worship procedures are not independently invented in this curriculum.
- Assessment is private and non-competitive. No public rankings, awards for spiritual performance or family comparisons.
- KUTUMBA supports temple participation, progressive sādhana and study readiness; it does not replace temple authority, initiation procedures or accredited Bhakti Śāstrī study.

3. Standard Friday Architecture

Time	Function
6:15–6:30	Arrival, attendance, bhoga handoff, setup, children settled, phones silenced
6:30–7:00	Kīrtana and worship according to approved standards
7:00–7:20	Prem-kī-Kathā: family problem, scripture, principle, analogy and application
7:20–8:00	Parallel parent and age-banded child formation
8:00–8:20	Bhakti laboratory: practical devotional skill
8:20–8:30	Family saṅkalpa: one achievable home commitment
8:30–9:00	Prasāda, supervised serving and formal close

4. Age-Band Delivery Model

4-6: Bāla I (ages 4–6): concrete, sensory, movement-based, one principle and one action.

7-9: Bāla II (ages 7–9): story, sequence, comparison, short verse phrase and guided application.

10-13: Kīśora (ages 10–13): evidence, scenario analysis, short text work, discussion and service responsibility.

Mixed-age rule: teach one common spiritual principle, then vary vocabulary, duration, abstraction, reading load, movement and responsibility. Never make an older child the sole supervisor of younger children.

5. Learning and Assessment Model

Every week develops	Assessment checks
• Knowledge: what is understood from authorized sources • Skill: what the participant can demonstrate • Practice: what is repeated at home	• Recall or recognition of the key principle • Explanation in the participant's own words • Application to a realistic family case

- Character: what disposition is cultivated

- Demonstration of the bhakti laboratory competency

Use only three private ratings: demonstrated, developing, and needs support. The purpose is instructional adjustment, not status.

6. Six-Month Curriculum Map

Code	Cycle	Active-week title	Key verse	Home method
C1-W1	Cycle 1	What Is KUTUMBA, and Why Are We Here?	Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.2.18	Hold one five-minute family practice before the next meeting: one prayer, three mahā-mantras and one appreciation.
C1-W2	Cycle 1	I Am Not This Body	Bhagavad-gītā 2.13	Use the identity pause once daily at a chosen trigger.
C1-W3	Cycle 1	The Nature of the Soul	Bhagavad-gītā 2.20	Offer one routine action to Kṛṣṇa daily with a ten-second intention.
C1-W4	Cycle 1	Why Human Life Is Rare and Valuable	Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.9.29	Protect one fifteen-minute family spiritual appointment.
C1-W5	Cycle 1	The Temporary World and the Search for Permanent Happiness	Bhagavad-gītā 8.15	Before one enjoyable activity, pause for gratitude and three mahā-mantras.
C1-W6	Cycle 1	Integration Night: Who Am I, and How Should Our Family Live?	Bhagavad-gītā 2.13	Continue one selected Cycle 1 practice during the off week.
C2-W1	Cycle 2	Action and Reaction: How Karma Binds	Bhagavad-gītā 3.9	Use the before–during–after method once on a routine duty.
C2-W2	Cycle 2	Free Will and Responsibility: The Next Choice Matters	Bhagavad-gītā 18.63	Use pause–remember–choose once daily on the chosen trigger.
C2-W3	Cycle 2	Birth, Death and Reincarnation	Bhagavad-gītā 2.22	Complete the one-minute bedtime remembrance three nights.
C2-W4	Cycle 2	The Three Modes of Material Nature	Bhagavad-gītā 14.5	Complete one five-minute environment reset before family chanting or reading.
C2-W5	Cycle 2	Māyā: Decorating the Prison Cell	Bhagavad-gītā 7.14	Use one media or consumption boundary for three days.
C2-W6	Cycle 2	Integration Night: Choice, Consequence and the Modes	Bhagavad-gītā 18.63	Continue one selected Cycle 2 method during the off week.
C3-W1	Cycle 3	Who Is God? The Supreme Enjoyer, Proprietor and Friend	Bhagavad-gītā 5.29	Before one daily duty, remember: Kṛṣṇa owns, Kṛṣṇa enjoys, Kṛṣṇa is friend.
C3-W2	Cycle 3	Who Is Kṛṣṇa? The Supreme Personality of Godhead	Bhagavad-gītā 7.7	Remember one name or quality of Kṛṣṇa once daily.
C3-W3	Cycle 3	Guru, Sādhū and Śāstra: How We Receive Spiritual Knowledge	Bhagavad-gītā 4.34	Write one sincere spiritual question and locate one relevant Śrīla Prabhupāda source.
C3-W4	Cycle 3	Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu and the Holy Name	Caitanya-caritāmṛta Antya 20.12 — Śikṣāṣṭakam 1	Five-minute family kīrtana or attentive mantra listening on three days.
C3-W5	Cycle 3	The Nine Processes of Bhakti	Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 7.5.23–24	Continue the family's core practice and add one underused process once.

Code	Cycle	Active-week title	Key verse	Home method
C3-W6	Cycle 3	Bhakti Mela: Kīrtana, Drama and Family Presentation	Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 7.5.23–24	Begin the thirty-day baseline with the smallest daily practice.

7. Source and Copyright Use

- Teachers should read the assigned verses and purports directly before teaching; slide summaries are not substitutes for source study.
- This curriculum generally paraphrases translations and purports rather than reproducing long copyrighted passages.
- Use authorized books, Bhaktivedanta VedaBase or institution-approved copies. Preserve exact verse references in slides and worksheets.
- No teacher may add speculative cosmology, private revelation, invented pastime details or unauthorised ritual procedure.

8. Contents

Cycle 1 — Identity and the Human Problem

- C1-W1 — What Is KUTUMBA, and Why Are We Here?
- C1-W2 — I Am Not This Body
- C1-W3 — The Nature of the Soul
- C1-W4 — Why Human Life Is Rare and Valuable
- C1-W5 — The Temporary World and the Search for Permanent Happiness
- C1-W6 — Integration Night: Who Am I, and How Should Our Family Live?

Week 7 is a complete KUTUMBA off week. Families continue only the one chosen continuity practice; no group meeting, assignment chase or make-up class.

Cycle 2 — Karma, Rebirth and Material Nature

- C2-W1 — Action and Reaction: How Karma Binds
- C2-W2 — Free Will and Responsibility: The Next Choice Matters
- C2-W3 — Birth, Death and Reincarnation
- C2-W4 — The Three Modes of Material Nature
- C2-W5 — Māyā: Decorating the Prison Cell
- C2-W6 — Integration Night: Choice, Consequence and the Modes

Week 7 is a complete off week. No meeting or make-up assignment. Families continue one selected Cycle 2 method only.

Cycle 3 — Kṛṣṇa, Guru and the Process of Bhakti

- C3-W1 — Who Is God? The Supreme Enjoyer, Proprietor and Friend
- C3-W2 — Who Is Kṛṣṇa? The Supreme Personality of Godhead
- C3-W3 — Guru, Sādhū and Śāstra: How We Receive Spiritual Knowledge
- C3-W4 — Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu and the Holy Name
- C3-W5 — The Nine Processes of Bhakti
- C3-W6 — Bhakti Mela: Kīrtana, Drama and Family Presentation

Week 7 is a complete off week. Families begin the thirty-day baseline without group programming or additional assignments.

Cycle 1 — Identity and the Human Problem

Cycle driving question

Who am I, why is human life valuable, and why do temporary arrangements fail to satisfy the soul permanently?

Cycle outcomes

- Families can distinguish body and soul without neglecting bodily responsibilities.
- Families understand the soul as eternal, individual, minute and related to Kṛṣṇa through service.
- Families protect one small spiritual appointment because human life is rare and purposeful.
- Families can enjoy temporary gifts gratefully without demanding permanent fulfillment from them.

Memorization and recognition

Primary cycle verse: Bhagavad-gītā 2.13. Recognition verses: BG 2.20, ŚB 11.9.29 and BG 8.15.

Protected off week

Week 7 is a complete KUTUMBA off week. Families continue only the one chosen continuity practice; no group meeting, assignment chase or make-up class.

C1-W1 — What Is KUTUMBA, and Why Are We Here?

Cycle 1 — Identity and the Human Problem

Field	Detail
Week code	C1-W1
Cycle function	Foundational principle and family orientation
Purpose	Establish KUTUMBA as a disciplined family sādhana and formation community—not a social club, substitute temple, initiation pathway, or lecture series—and help every family choose one realistic way to grow together.
Key verse	Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.2.18 — nityaṁ bhāgavata-sevayā
Memory line	Regular hearing and service cleanse the heart and make devotion steady.
Bhakti laboratory	Family Sacred-Space Reset
Minimum home practice	Hold one five-minute family practice before the next meeting: one prayer, three mahā-mantras and one appreciation.

Learning Outcomes

Outcome domain	By the end of the session, participants should be able to...
Knowledge	- State the six purposes of KUTUMBA in simple language. - Explain why regular hearing, association and service gradually strengthen devotion. - Distinguish KUTUMBA from temple governance, formal Bhakti Śāstrī study and initiation procedures.
Skill	- Participate in a short guided family discussion without interrupting, advising or comparing. - Convert a broad spiritual intention into one specific weekly practice.
Practice	- Complete the first family saṅkalpa and place it visibly at home. - Begin a five-minute weekly family check-in using appreciation, challenge and next step.
Character	Humility, reliability, non-comparison, respectful speech and willingness to serve.
Child	- Say, 'Our family can help one another remember Kṛṣṇa.' - Name one way children can hear, chant, serve or show respect at KUTUMBA.

Primary Śrīla Prabhupāda Sources

- Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.2.17–21, especially 1.2.18
- Bhagavad-gītā 9.14
- Caitanya-caritāmṛta Madhya 22.128–129 (five powerful practices of bhakti)
- KUTUMBA Master Operating Model: identity, six charter purposes and Friday flow

Key verse

Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.2.18

nityaṁ bhāgavata-sevayā

Teaching memory line: Regular hearing and service cleanse the heart and make devotion steady.

Prem-kī-Kathā Script

Delivery target: 8–10 minutes of scripted narration plus 5–7 minutes of interaction. Do not exceed the 20-minute block.

Friday evening has finally arrived. One parent is tired from work, another is worried about unfinished chores, one child wants a tablet, and another asks whether KUTUMBA is only another class. This is the real starting point: a family does not become Kṛṣṇa conscious because everyone already feels inspired. A family grows because, despite ordinary pressure, it repeatedly creates a protected place for hearing, chanting, service and honest improvement.

Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam describes the young Nārada in his previous life. He did not begin as a famous sage. As the son of a maidservant, he received the association of saintly persons, served them, heard from them and honored their remnants. That regular contact changed the direction of his life. The lesson is not that one weekly meeting performs magic while the rest of life remains untouched. The lesson is that sincere association, hearing and service create a repeated current. When the current continues, the heart changes.

KUTUMBA is meant to create that current inside family life. Parents do not drop children at a spiritual activity and remain spectators. Children do not carry the burden of making the home devotional. The family learns together, practices at an age-appropriate level, serves the temple and devotees, and makes one small commitment that can actually be kept.

Think of a garden. A family may buy excellent seeds and read every book about gardening. But without regular water, sunlight, weeding and patient care, there is no harvest. Kīrtana is water. Śāstra is sunlight. Service removes weeds of selfishness. Good association protects the plant. The Friday gathering is not the entire garden; it trains the family to care for the garden during the remaining six days.

Tonight, do not promise a dramatic transformation. Choose one honest beginning. Perhaps the family will chant together for five minutes twice this week, offer one meal carefully, read one verse after dinner, or complete one service without complaint. Kṛṣṇa consciousness grows through sincere repetition, not performance. Our question is not, 'Which family looks most advanced?' It is, 'Did our family take one truthful step toward Kṛṣṇa?'

Parent Lesson — 40 Minutes

- 1.0–5 min — Silent arrival question: 'What do I want my home to feel like spiritually one year from now?' Each adult writes privately.
- 2.5–10 min — Read the memory line from ŚB 1.2.18. Facilitator explains book Bhāgavata, devotee Bhāgavata, regularity and service without giving a long purport lecture.
- 3.10–18 min — Six-purpose card sort. Families match the charter purposes with examples: home chanting, temple service, respectful correction, festival participation, study readiness and family cooperation.
- 4.18–28 min — Case study: a family attends every Friday but has no home practice; another practices at home but withdraws from temple association. Discuss what each is missing and how to rebalance without criticism.
- 5.28–35 min — Family operating agreement: each couple or adult household identifies one support they need and one contribution they can reliably make.
- 6.35–40 min — Draft the first saṅkalpa using the formula: specific action + frequency + trigger + minimum version.

Children's Parallel Lesson — 40 Minutes

Common child timing: 0–5 opening/recall; 5–15 story or text; 15–28 movement, art, game or investigation; 28–35 verse/recall; 35–40 cleanup and family transition.

Age 4-6

- Story focus: young Nārada helps saintly visitors and listens carefully.
- Movement game: four corners labeled Hear, Chant, Serve and Respect. Children move to the corner named in a short scenario.
- Craft: family garden sheet; place one paper seed for each devotional action the family wants to grow.
- Recall phrase: 'We help each other remember Kṛṣṇa.'

Age 7-9

- Sequence cards: Nārada serves, hears, honors prasāda, remembers and grows.
- Team task: sort activities into 'helps our bhakti garden,' 'can be offered to Kṛṣṇa,' and 'needs a boundary.'
- Create a one-week family practice bookmark with one action and two check boxes.
- Verse phrase: nityaṁ bhāgavata-sevayā.

Age 10-13

- Read a short facilitator-prepared excerpt summary of ŚB 1.2.18 and identify the repeated actions and promised result.
- Discuss the difference between attendance, belonging and actual practice.
- Analyze two mini-cases: spiritual competition and passive spectatorship.
- Choose one youth service that is helpful but does not make the youth responsible for adult safety or discipline.

Analogy and Practical Example

Analogy A devotional family is a garden: hearing is sunlight, chanting is water, service is weeding, and association is protection.	Practical family example Instead of ‘We will become serious devotees,’ a family chooses: ‘On Tuesday and Thursday after brushing teeth, we will sit before the altar and chant one full mahā-mantra together three times. If the evening fails, we do the minimum version once before bed.’
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Questions: Discovery, Understanding and Application

Discovery

- Which repeated activities in ŚB 1.2.18 produce steadiness?
- Where do you already see hearing, chanting, service or remembrance in your home?
- Which KUTUMBA purpose feels most necessary for your family now?

Understanding

- Why is weekly attendance alone insufficient?
- How can family practice avoid comparison and still include accountability?
- Why must KUTUMBA increase temple participation rather than replace it?

Application

- What is the smallest practice your family can keep even during a difficult week?
- What behavior would make another family feel safe and respected here?
- What service can your family learn before rotating into responsibility?

Bhakti Laboratory — Family Sacred-Space Reset

- Show a simple sample sacred space: clean cloth, approved image or small altar arrangement, one scripture and safe lamp placement.
- Families inspect a mock setup and identify what supports cleanliness, attention and safety.
- Demonstrate a two-minute arrival routine: wash hands, silence phones, sit together, offer praṇāma and begin.
- Each family sketches where a realistic sacred space or reading basket can be maintained at home.

Competency check

Family can describe a clean, safe and sustainable home sacred space without inventing worship procedures.

Family Home Practice

Field	Detail
Minimum	Hold one five-minute family practice before the next meeting: one prayer, three mahā-mantras and one appreciation.
Standard	Complete the minimum practice twice and place the family saṅkalpa card near the sacred space.
Stretch	Add one short reading from Bhagavad-gītā or Kṛṣṇa Book and one small family service.
Evidence	One private check mark per completion; no photo proof or public reporting required.

Slide Outline

- KUTUMBA: Families Growing in Kṛṣṇa Consciousness
- Why families need a protected weekly rhythm
- ŚB 1.2.18: regular hearing and service
- The six charter purposes
- What KUTUMBA is—and is not
- The bhakti garden analogy

17. Friday flow and family responsibility
18. How to write a realistic saṅkalpa
19. This week's home practice

Teacher Preparation

- Read ŚB 1.2.17–21 and the KUTUMBA charter sections; prepare a three-minute explanation only.
- Print purpose cards, saṅkalpa cards, age-band activities and family covenant summary.
- Prepare the mock sacred-space materials; confirm that no unapproved worship procedure will be taught.
- Assign children to bands and confirm two-adult visible-space coverage.
- Brief all volunteers: no family comparison, no public disclosure of private practice, no theological improvisation.

Required Materials

Materials A	Materials B
• Six charter-purpose card sets • Saṅkalpa cards and pencils • Paper garden and seed cutouts • Four-corner signs • Mock sacred-space items	• Approved images/scripture • Child name tags • Timer • Whiteboard or chart paper

Assessment

- Adult exit response: state one purpose of KUTUMBA and one boundary.
- Facilitator listens for a saṅkalpa that is specific, measurable and small enough to keep.
- Children correctly match at least two scenarios to Hear, Chant, Serve or Respect.
- No score comparison. Record only: demonstrated, developing or needs support.

Newcomer Adaptation

KUTUMBA Setu application

Provide the one-page KUTUMBA orientation card before the session. Pair the family with a mentor family for the charter card sort. Do not ask newcomers to disclose personal sādhanā or take a service role. Their home practice is the minimum version only.

Risks and Sensitive Points

- Do not present KUTUMBA as official ISKCON certification, an alternative temple, or an initiation qualification program.
- Do not pressure families into identical chanting targets or public reporting.
- Do not let orientation become a 40-minute policy lecture; teach through cards and cases.
- Do not assign ritual roles before training and review.

Printable Worksheet — C1-W1

What Is KUTUMBA, and Why Are We Here?

Key verse and memory line

Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.2.18

Regular hearing and service cleanse the heart and make devotion steady.

Our family hopes KUTUMBA will help us become more _____.

The KUTUMBA purpose we most need now is _____ because _____.

One practice we already do reasonably well: _____.

One obstacle that usually interrupts family bhakti: _____.

Our one-week saṅkalpa: On [day/time], after [trigger], we will [action] for [duration]. Minimum version: _____.

Child box: Draw or write one way you can help your family remember Kṛṣṇa.

This Week's Saṅkalpa

Specific action: _____

Day/time and trigger: _____

Minimum version: _____

How we will review it: _____

C1-W2 — I Am Not This Body

Cycle 1 — Identity and the Human Problem

Field	Detail
Week code	C1-W2
Cycle function	Foundational principle
Purpose	Help adults and children distinguish the changing body from the continuing conscious self, while learning to care for the body as Kṛṣṇa's instrument rather than neglect or despise it.
Key verse	Bhagavad-gītā 2.13 — dehino 'smin yathā dehe
Memory line	The body changes from childhood to old age, but the conscious self continues.
Bhakti laboratory	Identity Pause and Japa Posture
Minimum home practice	Use the identity pause once daily at a chosen trigger.

Learning Outcomes

Outcome domain	By the end of the session, participants should be able to...
Knowledge	- Explain the body–self distinction using Bhagavad-gītā 2.13. - Identify bodily change as evidence that the conscious person persists through different bodily stages. - State that spiritual identity does not cancel bodily duties, health care, safety or respect for differences.
Skill	- Use precise language: 'I have a body' rather than treating the body as the complete self. - Apply body–self understanding to praise, criticism, aging and appearance pressure.
Practice	Pause once daily and remember: 'I am Kṛṣṇa's eternal servant; this body is for service.'
Character	Respect, sobriety, reduced vanity and reduced contempt toward self or others.
Child	- Recognize that the same person remains through baby, child and older-body stages. - Name one way to care for the body so it can serve Kṛṣṇa.

Primary Śrīla Prabhupāda Sources

- Bhagavad-gītā 2.13
- Bhagavad-gītā 2.16–18
- Bhagavad-gītā 13.1–3
- Śrīla Prabhupāda lectures and purports on dehī and deha as reflected in the assigned verses

Key verse

Bhagavad-gītā 2.13

dehino 'smin yathā dehe

Teaching memory line: The body changes from childhood to old age, but the conscious self continues.

Prem-kī-Kathā Script

Delivery target: 8–10 minutes of scripted narration plus 5–7 minutes of interaction. Do not exceed the 20-minute block.

A child finds an old family photo and laughs: 'Dad, that cannot be you. You had so much hair!' Everyone laughs, but the photo raises a serious question. The baby body is gone. The school-age body is gone. Even the cells and appearance have changed. Yet the person says, 'That was me.' Who is the 'me' that connects all those changing pictures?

On the battlefield, Arjuna was overwhelmed by seeing relatives and teachers before him. Kṛṣṇa did not dismiss his relationships or bodily responsibilities. He began by teaching identity. In Bhagavad-gītā 2.13, Kṛṣṇa explains that the embodied self passes through childhood, youth and old age, and similarly passes to another body at death. A sober person is not bewildered by change.

This teaching is not a license to neglect the body. A driver is not the car, but a responsible driver maintains the car because it is needed for the journey. In the same way, we feed, rest, protect and treat the body because it can be used in Kṛṣṇa's service. We do not worship appearance, and we do not abuse or ignore the body.

Body labels can be useful for ordinary responsibilities, but they do not describe the full self. Age, profession, nationality, skin color, ability, success and failure all belong to a changing condition. The soul is a conscious living being and an eternal part of Kṛṣṇa. When we forget this, praise can make us proud and criticism can crush us. When we remember it, we can receive feedback without losing our worth.

Imagine an actor wearing different costumes. A crown does not turn the actor into a real king, and a torn costume does not make the actor worthless. The costume affects the scene, so it must be handled properly, but the actor is more than the costume. Our body is a temporary, meaningful costume for service.

This week, when the mirror, a comment, pain, tiredness or comparison pulls your mind into bodily identity, pause. Say: 'This body is changing. I am the conscious servant of Kṛṣṇa. How can I use this situation in service?' That one pause turns philosophy into practice.

Parent Lesson — 40 Minutes

20. 0–5 min — Photo timeline: silently note three major bodily changes and one sense of continuity.
21. 5–12 min — Read BG 2.13. Identify the changing elements, the continuing subject and the expected attitude of a sober person.
22. 12–20 min — Facilitator demonstration with three labeled jackets: child, adult, elder. One volunteer changes jackets while keeping the same name card.
23. 20–30 min — Case study: a teenager is mocked for appearance; a parent fears aging; another devotee neglects sleep saying, 'I am not the body.' Groups identify wrong conclusions and balanced responses.
24. 30–36 min — Language practice: replace five identity statements ('I am ugly,' 'I am my job,' 'I am too old') with truthful, non-denying statements.
25. 36–40 min — Choose one daily trigger for the identity pause.

Children's Parallel Lesson — 40 Minutes

Common child timing: 0–5 opening/recall; 5–15 story or text; 15–28 movement, art, game or investigation; 28–35 verse/recall; 35–40 cleanup and family transition.

Age 4-6

- Show baby, child and current photos of a volunteer with permission; children identify the same person.
- Costume relay: one child wears different safe costume pieces while holding the same name card.
- Care-for-the-instrument game: sort sleep, bathing, prasāda, hitting, exercise and unsafe behavior.
- Recall: 'I have a body. I am a soul. I belong to Kṛṣṇa.'

Age 7-9

- Build a three-stage body timeline and place one 'same person' thread through all stages.
- Discuss why 'not the body' does not mean 'ignore the body.'
- Scenario cards on appearance, winning, injury and disability; choose a respectful response.
- Practice the first line of BG 2.13 with rhythm.

Age 10-13

- Text observation of BG 2.13: what changes, what continues, what conclusion follows?
- Analyze social-media identity pressure and the difference between self-care and image obsession.
- Debate the false statement: 'Because I am not the body, bodily harm and boundaries do not matter.'
- Write a one-sentence identity statement grounded in service.

Analogy and Practical Example

Analogy The body is like a vehicle or costume: valuable for a purpose, but not the complete person using it.	Practical family example After receiving a critical comment about appearance, instead of reacting or pretending not to care, a parent says: 'The comment hurt, but my worth is not decided by appearance. I will care for my health and use this body in service.'
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Questions: Discovery, Understanding and Application

Discovery

- What bodily stages are named in BG 2.13?
- Who is the subject passing through those stages?
- What signs of continuity do you notice in your own life?

Understanding

- Why does bodily change support the distinction between body and self?
- Why is neglecting health a misuse of this teaching?
- How does bodily identification intensify comparison?

Application

- Which label most strongly controls your mood?
- How can your family speak about bodies without vanity or shame?
- What one act of body care will better support service this week?

Bhakti Laboratory — Identity Pause and Japa Posture

26. Demonstrate stable, respectful sitting or walking posture without forcing children to remain still beyond capacity.
27. Guide three slow breaths; remind participants that breath and body are observed by the conscious self.
28. Chant one round section or five minutes together with attention to hearing.
29. Before and after, repeat: 'I am not this changing body; I am Kṛṣṇa's servant, using this body to hear and chant.'

Competency check

Participant can enter a brief chanting practice with safe posture and articulate the body-as-instrument principle.

Family Home Practice

Field	Detail
Minimum	Use the identity pause once daily at a chosen trigger.
Standard	Use the pause daily and complete one body-care action that supports service: sleep routine, medication, movement, cleanliness or reduced screen use.
Stretch	Discuss one appearance or status pressure as a family using BG 2.13.
Evidence	Private reflection: What changed in my response after the pause?

Slide Outline

30. The old family photo question
31. BG 2.13: changing body, continuing self
32. Deha and dehī
33. The costume/vehicle analogy
34. What this teaching does not mean
35. Appearance, age and status pressure
36. Identity pause
37. Japa as hearing by the conscious self

38. Home practice

Teacher Preparation

- Read BG 2.13 and 13.1–3; avoid speculative claims about neuroscience or measuring the soul.
- Collect only consented photos or use generic age-stage images.
- Prepare safe costume pieces and scenario cards.
- Brief teachers not to invite discussion of body trauma, eating disorders or medical diagnoses in the group.
- Prepare an inclusive example for disability: the soul is not reduced by bodily ability, while support needs remain real.

Required Materials

Materials A • Age-stage images • Three jackets or costume pieces • Name card • Timeline sheets • Yarn or ribbon	Materials B • Scenario cards • Japa beads for demonstration • Floor chairs or cushions • Pencils and crayons
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Assessment

- Adult explains BG 2.13 without saying the body is unreal or irrelevant.
- Adult gives one balanced response to a bodily-identity scenario.
- Child identifies the same person through changing age pictures.
- Teacher records misconceptions for private follow-up, not public correction battles.

Newcomer Adaptation

KUTUMBA Setu application

Give a two-minute bridge explanation of soul, body and Kṛṣṇa as the source. Avoid testing Sanskrit. Pair children with a buddy for the timeline. New adults may observe rather than discuss personal appearance pressure.

Risks and Sensitive Points

- Never use 'not the body' to dismiss pain, illness, abuse, disability, gendered safety or medical care.
- Do not teach that emotions are fake; they are experiences requiring regulation and spiritual understanding.
- Avoid body shaming, weight comments and forced disclosure.
- Do not claim scientific proof beyond the scriptural and experiential reasoning presented.

Printable Worksheet — C1-W2

I Am Not This Body

Key verse and memory line

Bhagavad-gītā 2.13

The body changes from childhood to old age, but the conscious self continues.

Three things about my body that have changed: 1) ____ 2) ____ 3) ____.

The continuing 'I' notices _____.

A body label that sometimes controls me: _____.

Balanced truth: I am not only _____; I am _____ and can use this body for _____.

Body-care action supporting service this week: _____.

Child box: Draw yourself as a baby, now and older. Connect all three with one line labeled 'same soul.'

This Week's Saṅkalpa

Specific action: _____

Day/time and trigger: _____

Minimum version: _____

How we will review it: _____

C1-W3 — The Nature of the Soul

Cycle 1 — Identity and the Human Problem

Field	Detail
Week code	C1-W3
Cycle function	Scriptural principle and application
Purpose	Move beyond the negative statement 'not the body' to a positive understanding of the jīva as eternal, conscious, individual, minute and naturally related to Kṛṣṇa through service.
Key verse	Bhagavad-gītā 2.20 — ajo nityaḥ śāśvato 'yaṁ purāṇo
Memory line	The soul is unborn, eternal and not destroyed when the body is destroyed.
Bhakti laboratory	Service Intention and Cleanliness Seva
Minimum home practice	Offer one routine action to Kṛṣṇa daily with a ten-second intention.

Learning Outcomes

Outcome domain	By the end of the session, participants should be able to...
Knowledge	- Describe five qualities taught in the assigned texts: eternal, conscious, individual, unchanging through bodily change and a minute part of Kṛṣṇa. - Distinguish the individual soul from the Supreme Soul without teaching that the jīva becomes God.
Skill	- Support a statement about the soul with a verse reference rather than imagination. - Explain qualitative similarity and quantitative difference using a safe analogy.
Practice	Offer one daily action consciously as service rather than for ego or recognition.
Character	Dignity, responsibility, service identity and respect for every living being.
Child	- Say that every living being has a soul and should be treated with care. - Understand that Kṛṣṇa is unlimited and the soul is a tiny eternal part.

Primary Śrīla Prabhupāda Sources

- Bhagavad-gītā 2.17–25, especially 2.20
- Bhagavad-gītā 15.7
- Bhagavad-gītā 13.23 (distinguishing the Supersoul)
- Śrīla Prabhupāda's purport to Bhagavad-gītā 2.20

Key verse

Bhagavad-gītā 2.20

ajo nityaḥ śāśvato 'yaṁ purāṇo

Teaching memory line: The soul is unborn, eternal and not destroyed when the body is destroyed.

Prem-kī-Kathā Script

Delivery target: 8–10 minutes of scripted narration plus 5–7 minutes of interaction. Do not exceed the 20-minute block.

Last week we learned that the changing body is not the complete self. But merely saying what we are not leaves an empty space. A child may ask, 'Then what am I?' Bhagavad-gītā gives a positive answer. The soul is not a temporary blank or a piece of matter. The soul is an eternal, conscious individual.

Kṛṣṇa tells Arjuna that the soul is never born and never dies. The body undergoes beginning, growth, change and destruction, but the soul does not pass through those material transformations. Consciousness is the symptom by which we understand the soul's presence. The individual may forget, become confused or identify with a body, but individuality does not disappear.

Bhagavad-gītā 15.7 describes the living beings as eternal fragmental parts of Kṛṣṇa. Śrīla Prabhupāda explains qualitative oneness and quantitative difference. A spark has the nature of fire—it can give heat and light—but it is not the entire blazing fire. A drop of ocean water has salty quality, but it is not the ocean. Similarly, the jīva is spiritual and conscious, yet minute; Kṛṣṇa is unlimited and the source.

This protects us from two opposite errors. The first is worthlessness: 'I am nothing; my life has no meaning.' The second is false supremacy: 'I am the Supreme and answer to no one.' The devotional conclusion is different: 'I am an eternal part of Kṛṣṇa, and my nature is fulfilled in loving service.'

Consider a hand connected to the body. The hand is an individual part with a specific function. When it serves the whole body, it is nourished. If it tries to keep food for itself without giving it to the stomach, it cannot enjoy. This analogy is limited—Kṛṣṇa is a person, not merely a body-system—but it shows why service is not humiliation. Proper service reconnects the part with the whole.

Every living being therefore has spiritual dignity. A child, an elderly person, a difficult coworker and an animal are not disposable objects. We may need boundaries and consequences, but we do not deny the soul within. This week, choose one ordinary action—cooking, driving, studying, cleaning or helping a child—and consciously offer the effort to Kṛṣṇa.

Parent Lesson — 40 Minutes

39. 0–5 min — Retrieval: in pairs, state one correct and one incorrect conclusion from 'I am not this body.'
40. 5–13 min — Guided reading of BG 2.20. Mark words describing what the soul is and what the soul is not.
41. 13–20 min — Compare BG 15.7 and BG 13.23: individual jīva, material nature and the Supreme witness. Keep terminology introductory.
42. 20–28 min — Analogy lab: spark/fire, sunray/sun and hand/body. Groups identify what each analogy helps explain and where it can mislead.
43. 28–35 min — Case: a person says, 'All souls are spiritual, so I do not need authority or service.' Prepare a text-grounded response.
44. 35–40 min — Service reframing: select one disliked duty and rewrite its intention as service without pretending the duty is pleasant.

Children's Parallel Lesson — 40 Minutes

Common child timing: 0–5 opening/recall; 5–15 story or text; 15–28 movement, art, game or investigation; 28–35 verse/recall; 35–40 cleanup and family transition.

Age 4-6

- Light demonstration: one lamp can light several battery candles; each light is real but not the source lamp.
- Living/not-living sort using pictures; emphasize care for living beings.
- Service-body actions: hands can clean, feet can visit temple, voice can chant, ears can hear.
- Recall: 'I am an eternal soul, a tiny part of Kṛṣṇa.'

Age 7-9

- Five-quality shield: eternal, conscious, individual, tiny part of Kṛṣṇa, meant for service.
- Analogy check: what is similar and different between a spark and a fire?
- Compassion scenarios involving insects, pets, siblings and elderly persons.
- Practice the key Sanskrit phrase with call-and-response.

Age 10-13

- Close reading: list claims in BG 2.20 and compare with BG 15.7.
- Discuss why 'part of Kṛṣṇa' does not mean the individual soul is equal in power to Kṛṣṇa.
- Analyze dignity plus boundaries: respecting the soul does not require accepting harmful behavior.
- Choose one invisible service to complete without seeking credit.

Analogy and Practical Example

Analogy A spark shares the fiery quality of the fire but is tiny and dependent; similarly the soul is spiritual but not the unlimited Supreme.	Practical family example A parent cleaning after everyone can think, 'No one values me,' or can truthfully reframe: 'This duty needs fair cooperation, and tonight I will offer my portion to Kṛṣṇa while asking the family to carry its responsibilities.' Service is not silent exploitation.
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Questions: Discovery, Understanding and Application

Discovery

- Which qualities of the soul are stated in BG 2.20?
- What relationship is stated in BG 15.7?
- What symptom indicates the presence of the soul in Śrīla Prabhupāda's explanation?

Understanding

- What does qualitative similarity mean?
- Why does individuality continue in devotional philosophy?
- Why is service compatible with spiritual dignity?

Application

- Which daily duty can you reconnect to Kṛṣṇa?
- How can you show dignity to a difficult person while keeping a boundary?
- How can children serve without being overburdened?

Bhakti Laboratory — Service Intention and Cleanliness Seva

45. Demonstrate how to prepare a small worship or classroom area: gather, sort, wipe, return and inspect.
46. Assign age-appropriate tasks with adult oversight; no chemical handling by young children.
47. Before starting, everyone silently states the service intention.
48. Afterward, discuss the difference between finishing quickly, seeking praise and serving carefully.

Competency check

Participant completes one assigned task safely and can state whom the service is for.

Family Home Practice

Field	Detail
Minimum	Offer one routine action to Kṛṣṇa daily with a ten-second intention.
Standard	Complete one unnoticed family service without announcing it, then discuss at week's end what service identity changed.
Stretch	Read BG 2.20 together and have each family member choose one word describing the soul.
Evidence	Private note: duty, intention, obstacle and one improvement.

Slide Outline

49. What am I positively?
50. BG 2.20: unborn and eternal
51. Consciousness and the living being
52. BG 15.7: eternal fragmental part
53. Jīva and Supersoul
54. Spark and fire: value and limit
55. Service is connection, not worthlessness
56. Dignity and boundaries

57. Home service intention

Teacher Preparation

- Read BG 2.17–25, 15.7 and 13.23 with purports; use exact terminology and avoid monistic interpretations.
- Prepare a safe LED light demonstration rather than open flame for children.
- Check cleaning materials and child-safe task assignments.
- Brief facilitators that service does not justify domestic unfairness, coercion or abuse.
- Prepare glossary cards: jīva, ātmā, Paramātmā, prakṛti and sevā.

Required Materials

Materials A • LED lamp and battery candles • Living/not-living picture cards • Five-quality shield sheets • Glossary cards	Materials B • Cleaning cloths and child-safe supplies • Task labels • Verse sheet • Crayons and pencils
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Assessment

- Adult names at least three qualities of the soul and distinguishes jīva from Kṛṣṇa.
- Adult identifies one limit of the spark analogy.
- Child states that every living being has a soul and selects a caring action.
- Observe service quality: safe, cooperative and without public praise ranking.

Newcomer Adaptation

KUTUMBA Setu application

Give a glossary card and a two-sentence bridge from the prior week: body changes; the soul is the conscious self. Allow the newcomer to use the English memory line rather than Sanskrit.

Risks and Sensitive Points

- Do not teach that the individual soul merges and loses identity.
- Do not imply that every spark analogy detail is literal or complete.
- Do not use 'service' to normalize exploitation, lack of consent or unequal family burden.
- Avoid sentimental claims about identifying the destination or history of a particular soul.

Printable Worksheet — C1-W3

The Nature of the Soul

Key verse and memory line

Bhagavad-gītā 2.20

The soul is unborn, eternal and not destroyed when the body is destroyed.

From BG 2.20, the soul is _____, _____ and _____.

From BG 15.7, my relationship with Kṛṣṇa is _____.

The spark analogy helps explain _____ but does not mean _____.

One living being I will treat with greater care: _____.

My service action this week: _____. I will remember it is for _____.

Child box: Draw a small spark near a great fire and label 'tiny part' and 'great source.'

This Week's Saṅkalpa

Specific action: _____

Day/time and trigger: _____

Minimum version: _____

How we will review it: _____

C1-W4 — Why Human Life Is Rare and Valuable

Cycle 1 — Identity and the Human Problem

Field	Detail
Week code	C1-W4
Cycle function	Parent and child formation
Purpose	Teach that human intelligence carries a special opportunity and responsibility for self-realization, while avoiding contempt for animals, panic about death or achievement-based spiritual pressure.
Key verse	Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.9.29 — labdhvā su-durlabham idaṁ ... mānuṣyam artha-dam
Memory line	Human life is rare, temporary and able to give the highest value when used for spiritual realization.
Bhakti laboratory	How to Read One Verse as a Family
Minimum home practice	Protect one fifteen-minute family spiritual appointment.

Learning Outcomes

Outcome domain	By the end of the session, participants should be able to...
Knowledge	- Explain that human life is temporary yet uniquely capable of deliberate inquiry and devotional practice. - State the difference between using urgency wisely and living in fear. - Recognize childhood as a suitable time for gradual devotional formation.
Skill	- Audit time without shame and identify one reclaimable block. - Ask a meaningful spiritual question rather than seeking only information or entertainment.
Practice	Create one protected fifteen-minute family spiritual appointment this week.
Character	Gratitude, urgency, disciplined use of time and compassion for all species.
Child	- Say one special ability of human life: to ask, choose, pray, learn and serve intentionally. - Choose one age-appropriate devotional habit to practice now rather than 'when older.'

Primary Śrīla Prabhupāda Sources

- Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.9.29
- Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 7.6.1
- Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.2.10
- Bhagavad-gītā 7.19

Key verse

Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.9.29

labdhvā su-durlabham idaṁ ... mānuṣyam artha-dam

Teaching memory line: Human life is rare, temporary and able to give the highest value when used for spiritual realization.

Prem-kī-Kathā Script

Delivery target: 8–10 minutes of scripted narration plus 5–7 minutes of interaction. Do not exceed the 20-minute block.

A family receives a valuable pass that can be used only once. The pass opens a learning center containing guidance, tools and a path to a lasting destination. But the family keeps it in a drawer. They are busy choosing snacks, comparing phones and planning someday to visit. When the expiry date approaches, they panic. The problem was not enjoying ordinary responsibilities; the problem was forgetting the pass's unique purpose.

Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.9.29 describes human life as very difficult to obtain, temporary, yet capable of giving the highest benefit. The verse creates urgency, but not despair. It does not say to abandon family duties or become anxious every minute. It says to stop assuming that spiritual life can always be postponed.

Prahlāda Mahārāja similarly teaches that devotional practice can begin from childhood. Children do not need advanced philosophy or adult vows. They need loving habits: hearing Kṛṣṇa's names, offering respect, learning prayers, serving safely and seeing parents practice sincerely. Adults also should not say, 'After the project, after the children grow, after retirement.' Life rarely becomes empty enough for devotion by accident. We protect time because the purpose matters.

Human intelligence allows reflective questions: Who am I? Why do actions bind me? Who is Kṛṣṇa? What is loving service? Animals also have souls and deserve care, but the human form provides an unusual capacity to shape life around such inquiry. This does not make humans licensed exploiters. Greater capacity means greater responsibility.

Think of a fertile field available for one season. A wise farmer does not scream at the field because the season is short. The farmer becomes organized: select good seed, remove obvious weeds, water regularly and accept gradual growth. Our schedule is the field. We do not need thirty new practices. We need one protected appointment that proves spiritual life is not only leftover time.

This week, reclaim fifteen minutes. Put it on the calendar. Use it for family reading, chanting, a Kṛṣṇa story or service planning. When another demand appears, remember: many activities can be done in many forms of life, but conscious inquiry and loving devotional practice are the special opportunity of human life.

Parent Lesson — 40 Minutes

58. 0–5 min — Time snapshot: mark yesterday's waking hours in broad categories without names or public sharing.
59. 5–12 min — Read the memory line from ŚB 11.9.29 and identify three ideas: rare, temporary, value-giving.
60. 12–18 min — Read a short summary of ŚB 7.6.1. Discuss formation in childhood without imposing adult standards.
61. 18–28 min — 'Someday' case study: work pressure, children's activities, elder care and screens leave no protected spiritual time. Groups design a realistic fifteen-minute appointment.
62. 28–34 min — Question workshop: convert shallow or argumentative questions into inquiry that can guide practice.
63. 34–40 min — Calendar the family appointment and identify one likely interruption plus backup plan.

Children's Parallel Lesson — 40 Minutes

Common child timing: 0–5 opening/recall; 5–15 story or text; 15–28 movement, art, game or investigation; 28–35 verse/recall; 35–40 cleanup and family transition.

Age 4-6

- Gift box activity: inside are ears, voice, hands, heart and thinking symbols; children name how each can serve Kṛṣṇa.
- Story focus: young Prahlāda remembers and speaks about Kṛṣṇa even while young.
- Choice game: 'now or later?' for tiny devotional actions such as one prayer or helping set an altar cloth.
- Make a fifteen-minute family appointment ticket.

Age 7-9

- Compare abilities of plants, animals and humans without disrespect: deliberate questions, moral choices and worship.
- Read a child-level paraphrase of ŚB 7.6.1 and identify what can begin in childhood.
- Time-jar experiment with large rocks, pebbles and sand: important things require intentional placement.
- Create one question for Kṛṣṇa, guru, sādhu or śāstra.

Age 10-13

- Analyze 'temporary' versus 'meaningless.' Explain why a short opportunity can be highly valuable.
- Complete a private 24-hour attention audit and identify one low-value block.
- Discuss responsibility toward animals and the environment as souls within Kṛṣṇa's creation.
- Design a realistic youth spiritual appointment that does not depend entirely on parental reminders.

Analogy and Practical Example

Analogy Human life is a valuable, time-limited opportunity—like a fertile growing season that requires intentional planting, not panic.	Practical family example A working family cannot sustain a long morning program. They protect Sunday 7:30–7:45 p.m. for one Kṛṣṇa Book story and Tuesday bedtime for three minutes of chanting. The plan is modest but real.
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Questions: Discovery, Understanding and Application

Discovery

- What three qualities of human life appear in ŚB 11.9.29?
- What does Prahāda recommend beginning in childhood?
- Which ordinary human activities are also available in animal life?

Understanding

- Why does temporary not mean worthless?
- What is the difference between urgency and anxiety?
- Why does greater human capacity create responsibility rather than superiority?

Application

- Which fifteen minutes can your family protect this week?
- What spiritual question deserves continued study?
- What activity is consuming time without giving proportionate value?

Bhakti Laboratory — How to Read One Verse as a Family

64. Display one verse reference and memory line; do not attempt the entire purport with young children.
65. Use the four-step method: hear/read, notice one word, explain in own words, choose one action.
66. Parents practice asking one discovery question and one application question without answering for the child.
67. Families complete a seven-minute trial reading using ŚB 11.9.29 or a child-appropriate summary.

Competency check

Family can conduct a short, interactive scripture moment without turning it into a lecture or test.

Family Home Practice

Field	Detail
Minimum	Protect one fifteen-minute family spiritual appointment.
Standard	Use the four-step verse method and write one family answer.
Stretch	Each person brings one sincere spiritual question to the next meeting.
Evidence	Calendar check and one-sentence reflection; missed appointments are rescheduled, not hidden.

Slide Outline

68. The one-use opportunity
69. ŚB 11.9.29: rare, temporary, value-giving
70. Childhood formation: ŚB 7.6.1
71. Urgency without fear
72. Greater capacity, greater responsibility
73. The growing-season analogy
74. Time audit without shame
75. Four-step family verse method
76. Protected appointment

Teacher Preparation

- Read ŚB 11.9.29, 7.6.1 and 1.2.10; prepare age-appropriate paraphrases rather than graphic death emphasis.
- Prepare time-jar materials and private time-audit sheets.
- Ensure no teacher tells families to neglect work, school, health or elder-care obligations.
- Prepare examples for single-parent, shift-work and caregiving households.
- Brief teachers to respect animals and avoid derogatory species comparisons.

Required Materials

Materials A • Gift box and symbol cards • Large jar, rocks, pebbles and sand • Calendars or blank weekly grids • Verse-method cards	Materials B • Appointment tickets • Pencils • Timer • Chart paper
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Assessment

- Adult explains rare + temporary + value-giving without panic language.
- Family successfully demonstrates the four-step reading process.
- Child names one intentional human capacity and one devotional use.
- Review appointments privately for realism, not quantity.

Newcomer Adaptation

KUTUMBA Setu application

Provide the body–soul bridge card and explain that this lesson focuses on opportunity, not prior knowledge. New families may choose a ten-minute appointment. Mentor family checks in once, without policing.

Risks and Sensitive Points

- Avoid frightening children with death or lower-birth threats.
- Do not demean animals or imply permission to exploit them.
- Do not equate busyness with spiritual failure; focus on intentional redesign.
- Do not impose adult sādhanā targets on children.

Printable Worksheet — C1-W4

Why Human Life Is Rare and Valuable

Key verse and memory line

Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.9.29

Human life is rare, temporary and able to give the highest value when used for spiritual realization.

Human life is rare because _____.

Human life is temporary, so I should not keep postponing _____.

Human life gives value when used for _____.

Our protected fifteen-minute appointment: day ____ time ____ place ____.

Likely interruption: _____. Backup plan: _____.

My sincere spiritual question: _____.

This Week's Saṅkalpa

Specific action: _____

Day/time and trigger: _____

Minimum version: _____

How we will review it: _____

C1-W5 — The Temporary World and the Search for Permanent Happiness

Cycle 1 — Identity and the Human Problem

Field	Detail
Week code	C1-W5
Cycle function	Case study, practice and worldview application
Purpose	Help families honestly recognize the limits of material arrangements, distinguish healthy enjoyment from the demand that temporary things provide permanent fulfillment, and redirect desire toward Kṛṣṇa-centered happiness.
Key verse	Bhagavad-gītā 8.15 — duḥkhālayam aśāśvatam
Memory line	This material world is temporary and cannot provide permanent freedom from distress; lasting fulfillment comes through attaining Kṛṣṇa.
Bhakti laboratory	Offering an Ordinary Activity to Kṛṣṇa
Minimum home practice	Before one enjoyable activity, pause for gratitude and three mahā-mantras.

Learning Outcomes

Outcome domain	By the end of the session, participants should be able to...
Knowledge	- Explain aśāśvatam as temporary and connect it with recurring change, separation and frustration. - State that the material world is Kṛṣṇa's energy and can be used in service; it is not to be hated or neglected. - Distinguish pleasure, relief, meaning and lasting spiritual happiness.
Skill	- Examine an expectation and identify whether a temporary object is being asked to provide permanent security or identity. - Practice gratitude without attachment and detachment without coldness.
Practice	Offer one enjoyable family activity to Kṛṣṇa by adding remembrance, gratitude or service.
Character	Contentment, realism, gratitude and reduced entitlement.
Child	- Recognize that toys, treats and winning can be enjoyable but do not stay forever. - Name one happiness connected with Kṛṣṇa that grows through sharing and service.

Primary Śrīla Prabhupāda Sources

- Bhagavad-gītā 2.14
- Bhagavad-gītā 5.22
- Bhagavad-gītā 8.15
- Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.2.10
- Bhagavad-gītā 9.27

Key verse

Bhagavad-gītā 8.15

duḥkhālayam aśāśvatam

Teaching memory line: This material world is temporary and cannot provide permanent freedom from distress; lasting fulfillment comes through attaining Kṛṣṇa.

Prem-kī-Kathā Script

Delivery target: 8–10 minutes of scripted narration plus 5–7 minutes of interaction. Do not exceed the 20-minute block.

A family plans the perfect holiday. They choose the place, buy the clothes, arrange the food and imagine everyone smiling. Then the weather changes, a child becomes sick, the hotel room is noisy and two people argue. The holiday was not evil. The problem was the hidden demand: 'This arrangement must make us completely happy.'

Kṛṣṇa describes the material world as temporary and marked by distress. That can sound negative when heard without context. The point is not that every moment is painful or that devotees must reject beauty, family affection and responsible enjoyment. The point is that changing arrangements cannot carry the weight of permanent happiness. Bodies change, moods shift, possessions break, praise fades and loved ones cannot remain in the same bodily situation forever.

Bhagavad-gītā 2.14 teaches us to tolerate the seasonal appearance of happiness and distress. Bhagavad-gītā 5.22 warns that pleasures born from material contact have a beginning and an end. Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.2.10 directs human desire toward inquiry into truth rather than making sense gratification the central goal.

Think of drinking salty water when thirsty. It gives the sensation of drinking, but it increases the thirst. Repeated consumption, novelty and recognition can work like that when used to fill the soul's need for relationship with Kṛṣṇa. The object may have a proper use; the false expectation creates bondage.

Devotional life does not require a gray home where no one enjoys anything. Bhagavad-gītā 9.27 teaches that what we do, eat, offer and give can be offered to Kṛṣṇa. A picnic can include kīrtana and gratitude. A birthday can include prasāda and service. A talent can glorify Kṛṣṇa rather than inflate ego. The temporary is connected to the eternal through service.

This week, choose one enjoyable family activity. Before it begins, remember Kṛṣṇa; during it, keep one boundary; afterward, express gratitude and avoid demanding that the experience prove your family is successful. Enjoy the gift without asking the gift to become God.

Parent Lesson — 40 Minutes

77. 0–5 min — Private prompt: 'A temporary arrangement I secretly expect to make me secure is...' No forced sharing.
78. 5–12 min — Compare BG 2.14, 5.22 and 8.15. Identify temporary change, beginning/end and ultimate destination.
79. 12–20 min — Four-column exercise: pleasure, relief, meaning and spiritual nourishment. Classify examples; allow overlap but require reasons.
80. 20–30 min — Case studies: perfect family image, children's achievement, consumption after stress and spiritualized entertainment. Identify the legitimate need and the misplaced demand.
81. 30–35 min — Connection practice using BG 9.27: choose an ordinary activity and add offering, gratitude, restraint or service.
82. 35–40 min — Prepare one sentence for a child disappointed by a canceled event without dismissing feelings.

Children's Parallel Lesson — 40 Minutes

Common child timing: 0–5 opening/recall; 5–15 story or text; 15–28 movement, art, game or investigation; 28–35 verse/recall; 35–40 cleanup and family transition.

Age 4-6

- Bubble activity: bubbles are beautiful and temporary; enjoy without crying when each one pops.
- Story: a child shares prasāda and discovers joy in giving, not only receiving.
- Sort pictures into 'lasts a short time' and 'spiritual relationship grows through practice.'
- Gratitude prayer before a simple enjoyable activity.

Age 7-9

- Build and gently dismantle a block tower; discuss change without calling the tower bad.
- Four-happiness cards: pleasure, relief, meaning and bhakti nourishment.
- Scenario: losing a game or breaking a favorite item; practice naming disappointment and choosing the next right action.
- Plan a Kṛṣṇa-centered family fun activity.

Age 10-13

- Analyze advertising promises: what permanent need is attached to a temporary product?

- Discuss why detachment is not indifference and gratitude is not possession.
- Use BG 9.27 to redesign one entertainment, hobby or celebration.
- Create a 'beginning–middle–end' map for one desired experience.

Analogy and Practical Example

Analogy • Temporary pleasure is like salty water when treated as the soul's cure: it may stimulate but cannot remove the deeper thirst.	Practical family example • A family goes for ice cream. They chant briefly in the car, thank Kṛṣṇa, choose a reasonable portion, include a child who feels left out and return on time. The outing remains enjoyable but does not become uncontrolled consumption or the center of family identity.
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Questions: Discovery, Understanding and Application

Discovery

- What words in the assigned verses describe temporary experience?
- What is the difference between an enjoyable object and an expectation placed upon it?
- What does BG 9.27 invite us to do with ordinary activities?

Understanding

- Why is realism about suffering not pessimism?
- How can detachment increase care rather than reduce it?
- Why do repeated pleasures often fail to settle the mind permanently?

Application

- Which family activity can be connected to Kṛṣṇa this week?
- What boundary would protect that activity from excess?
- How will you respond when the plan changes?

Bhakti Laboratory — Offering an Ordinary Activity to Kṛṣṇa

83. Present four activity cards: meal, walk, music practice and celebration.
84. Families add four elements: remembrance before, devotional connection during, restraint/boundary and gratitude/service after.
85. Practice a simple gratitude prayer and one-minute kīrtana before a sample fruit snack.
86. Clarify that exact bhoga-offering procedures are taught only under approved worship guidance; this lab teaches intention and planning.

Competency check

Family can redesign one ordinary activity so Kṛṣṇa remains central without making it artificial or burdensome.

Family Home Practice

Field	Detail
Minimum	Before one enjoyable activity, pause for gratitude and three mahā-mantras.
Standard	Add a boundary and one service element; discuss afterward what was enjoyable and what remained temporary.
Stretch	Complete a one-day 'expectation audit' whenever irritation arises: What did I demand from this person or object?
Evidence	One short family reflection; no need to report the cost or details publicly.

Slide Outline

87. The perfect holiday expectation

- 88. BG 8.15: temporary world
- 89. BG 2.14 and 5.22: change and endings
- 90. Pleasure, relief, meaning and spiritual nourishment
- 91. The salty-water analogy
- 92. Temporary does not mean evil
- 93. BG 9.27: connecting ordinary life
- 94. Family fun with boundaries
- 95. Home activity redesign

Teacher Preparation

- Read BG 2.14, 5.22, 8.15, 9.27 and SB 1.2.10 with purports.
- Prepare examples that do not shame income level, possessions, travel or family recreation.
- Prepare bubbles or block materials and ensure allergy-safe fruit if used.
- Brief teachers to validate disappointment before offering philosophy.
- Avoid making claims about a grieving family's detachment or karma.

Required Materials

Materials A	Materials B
• Bubbles or block set • Four-happiness cards • Advertising samples without inappropriate content • Activity redesign cards	• Fruit snack and serving items • Worksheet • Timer • Chart paper

Assessment

- Adult distinguishes temporary from evil and detachment from indifference.
- Family produces a four-part Kṛṣṇa-centered activity plan.
- Child names that disappointment is real but does not last forever.
- Facilitator checks for shame, denial or material hatred and corrects privately.

Newcomer Adaptation

KUTUMBA Setu application

Offer the one-page cycle summary: soul, human opportunity and temporary conditions. New families may observe the case discussion and choose only the gratitude pause as home practice.

Risks and Sensitive Points

- Do not trivialize grief, poverty, illness or trauma with 'everything is temporary.'
- Do not portray family affection or responsible material duties as contamination.
- Do not shame children for enjoying toys, games or treats; teach proportion and connection.
- Avoid performative renunciation and forced sharing of private attachments.

Printable Worksheet — C1-W5

The Temporary World and the Search for Permanent Happiness

Key verse and memory line

Bhagavad-gītā 8.15

This material world is temporary and cannot provide permanent freedom from distress; lasting fulfillment comes through attaining Kṛṣṇa.

A temporary thing I enjoy: _____.

The deeper need I sometimes ask it to satisfy: _____.

Beginning: ____ Middle: ____ End: ____.

How we can connect this activity to Kṛṣṇa: before ____ during ____ after ____.

One healthy boundary: _____.

Child box: Draw something enjoyable and add a heart or name of Kṛṣṇa to show gratitude.

This Week's Saṅkalpa

Specific action: _____

Day/time and trigger: _____

Minimum version: _____

How we will review it: _____

C1-W6 — Integration Night: Who Am I, and How Should Our Family Live?

Cycle 1 — Identity and the Human Problem

Field	Detail
Week code	C1-W6
Cycle function	Integration, presentation, quiz, drama and family application
Purpose	Consolidate the first cycle through demonstration, not another lecture, and verify that families can connect identity, human purpose and temporary circumstances to one sustainable home practice.
Key verse	Bhagavad-gītā 2.13 — tathā dehāntara-prāptir dhīras tatra na muhyati
Memory line	A sober person understands bodily change and acts from spiritual identity.
Bhakti laboratory	Cycle 1 Learning Stations
Minimum home practice	Continue one selected Cycle 1 practice during the off week.

Learning Outcomes

Outcome domain	By the end of the session, participants should be able to...
Knowledge	- Connect the sequence: changing body → eternal soul → rare human opportunity → limits of temporary happiness. - Recall the central references BG 2.13, BG 2.20, ŚB 11.9.29 and BG 8.15 at recognition level.
Skill	- Explain one principle in two minutes using a verse, analogy and application. - Listen to another family's presentation and give one appreciation without comparison.
Practice	Review the first-cycle home practices and choose one to continue for the next seven weeks.
Character	Encouragement, honesty, teamwork and non-competitive celebration.
Child	- Participate in a short drama, station or explanation according to age and comfort. - Demonstrate one identity principle through picture, movement or words.

Primary Śrīla Prabhupāda Sources

- Review: Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.2.18
- Review: Bhagavad-gītā 2.13 and 2.20
- Review: Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.9.29
- Review: Bhagavad-gītā 8.15 and 9.27

Key verse

Bhagavad-gītā 2.13

tathā dehāntara-prāptir dhīras tatra na muhyati

Teaching memory line: A sober person understands bodily change and acts from spiritual identity.

Prem-kī-Kathā Script

Delivery target: 8–10 minutes of scripted narration plus 5–7 minutes of interaction. Do not exceed the 20-minute block.

A family begins a road journey. One child keeps asking, 'Are we there yet?' Another becomes attached to every rest stop and refuses to leave. A third complains that the car is not as nice as another family's car. The parents also forget the map and start arguing about who is responsible.

The body is like the vehicle: important, maintained and used, but not the traveler. The soul is the conscious traveler. Human life is the valuable opportunity to understand the destination and choose the right road. Temporary pleasures are like rest stops: useful and sometimes enjoyable, but not the final home. KUTUMBA is one place where families check the map, repair habits and travel together toward Kṛṣṇa.

A good integration night is not a competition to prove who remembers the most Sanskrit or whose children perform best. It is a service of remembrance. One family may explain with a drawing, another through drama, another with a practical example. The purpose is to make the principles usable.

Tonight, notice the chain. If I think I am only the body, I will treat temporary gain and loss as ultimate. When I remember I am an eternal soul, I can value human life differently. When I see human life as valuable, I protect time for hearing and service. When I understand the world is temporary, I can enjoy responsibly without demanding permanent fulfillment from changing things.

At the end, each family will choose one practice to carry forward. Not four. A plant grows when watering continues after the first excitement. The success of Cycle 1 is not a perfect presentation. It is that the family can say, with more clarity than six weeks ago: 'We are eternal servants of Kṛṣṇa, and our home is taking one real step in that direction.'

Parent Lesson — 40 Minutes

96. 0–5 min — Explain non-competitive rules and the appreciation-only response format.
97. 5–15 min — Mixed-family retrieval stations: verse match, analogy match and misconception repair.
98. 15–30 min — Three-minute family presentations or displays. Maximum four families in this block; remaining families present during lab stations.
99. 30–36 min — Adult case lightning round: appearance crisis, schedule pressure and canceled plan. Each response must include identity + action.
100. 36–40 min — Private continuity decision: start, continue, simplify or stop one home practice.

Children's Parallel Lesson — 40 Minutes

Common child timing: 0–5 opening/recall; 5–15 story or text; 15–28 movement, art, game or investigation; 28–35 verse/recall; 35–40 cleanup and family transition.

Age 4-6

- Costume parade showing one child under changing hats or scarves.
- Picture stations: body changes, soul stays, human hands serve, bubbles are temporary.
- Group chant with one child holding each word card of the memory line.
- Choose a sticker for one practice to continue; no prize ranking.

Age 7-9

- Mini-drama: traveler, vehicle, map and rest stop.
- Four-corner quiz with explanation after each answer.
- Create a cycle wheel connecting the four principles.
- Present one home-practice report: what helped, what interrupted and what will change.

Age 10-13

- Facilitate one station or present a two-minute evidence–analogy–application explanation.
- Misconception repair cards: 'not the body means health does not matter,' 'temporary means useless,' and 'all souls are God.'
- Peer appreciation using specific language: 'Your example helped me understand...'
- Write one question to carry into the karma cycle.

Analogy and Practical Example

Analogy	Practical family example
• Life is a journey: body as vehicle, soul as traveler, human intelligence as map-reading capacity, temporary pleasures as	• A family reports that its planned fifteen-minute reading happened only once. Instead of hiding failure, it identifies the

rest stops, and Kṛṣṇa as the ultimate destination and shelter.

cause—Friday exhaustion—and moves the practice to Sunday breakfast. Honest redesign is counted as progress.

Questions: Discovery, Understanding and Application

Discovery

- Which verse belongs to each principle?
- Which analogy clarified the difference between body and soul?
- Which home practice was actually completed?

Understanding

- How do the four lessons form one sequence?
- Which common misconception is most dangerous in family life?
- Why is honest simplification better than impressive failure?

Application

- Which practice will your family carry forward?
- What trigger and minimum version will protect it?
- What support do you need from the group without surrendering family responsibility?

Bhakti Laboratory — Cycle 1 Learning Stations

101. Station A — Body timeline and costume demonstration.
102. Station B — Soul-quality matching and spark analogy limit.
103. Station C — Time-jar appointment planning.
104. Station D — Temporary activity redesign with BG 9.27.
105. Families rotate every four minutes; one trained youth may assist but not supervise alone.

Competency check

Family demonstrates all four principles at recognition level and one principle at explanation/application level.

Family Home Practice

Field	Detail
Minimum	Continue one selected Cycle 1 practice during the off week.
Standard	Complete it twice and hold a five-minute cycle review: appreciation, obstacle and adjustment.
Stretch	Prepare one question about karma, choice or rebirth for Cycle 2.
Evidence	Private continuity card kept by the family; facilitator records only the chosen category, not personal details.

Slide Outline

106. Cycle 1 integration rules
107. The four-part learning chain
108. Verse recognition round
109. Misconception repair
110. Family presentations
111. Traveler–vehicle–map–rest-stop analogy
112. What actually changed at home?
113. Choose one continuity practice
114. Preview: action, choice and rebirth

Teacher Preparation

- Collect presentation format choices one week earlier; limit preparation burden to twenty minutes per family.
- Set up four stations with answer keys and age adaptations.
- Prepare a visible rule: no ranking, no scores announced, no correction during a child's performance unless safety requires it.

- Assign timekeeper, station leads and child-transition support.
- Review Cycle 1 misconceptions and prepare concise corrections with references.

Required Materials

Materials A • Station signs and answer cards • Costume pieces • Timeline and spark cards • Time jar • Activity redesign cards	Materials B • Family display space • Timer or bell • Appreciation slips • Continuity cards
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Assessment

- Use a four-domain rubric: recall, explanation, application and teamwork.
- Record each family as secure, developing or needs a mentor check-in; do not publish results.
- Children may demonstrate through action, drawing or speech; fluency and stage confidence are not the target.
- Facilitator identifies which Cycle 1 concept requires a five-minute review at the start of Cycle 2.

Newcomer Adaptation

KUTUMBA Setu application

A mid-cycle observer may participate in stations with a mentor but is not required to present. Provide the Cycle 1 one-page map and invite the family to complete Setu foundations before Cycle 2 entry.

Risks and Sensitive Points

- Integration can become a talent show; enforce time and non-comparison rules.
- Do not embarrass a family whose home practice failed.
- Do not reward memorization volume over understanding and application.
- Children may opt for a non-speaking role; participation must not become forced performance.

Printable Worksheet — C1-W6

Integration Night: Who Am I, and How Should Our Family Live?

Key verse and memory line

Bhagavad-gītā 2.13

A sober person understands bodily change and acts from spiritual identity.

Match: BG 2.13 = ____; BG 2.20 = ____; ŚB 11.9.29 = ____; BG 8.15 = ____.

Correct this statement: 'Because I am not the body, _____.'

Our clearest Cycle 1 insight: _____.

A practice that worked: _____. Why: _____.

A practice that did not work: _____. Adjustment: _____.

Practice we will carry forward: _____. Minimum version: _____.

This Week's Saṅkalpa

Specific action: _____

Day/time and trigger: _____

Minimum version: _____

How we will review it: _____

Cycle 2 — Karma, Rebirth and Material Nature

Cycle driving question

How do action, choice, conditioning and consciousness shape our present and future, and how do we seek shelter beyond māyā?

Cycle outcomes

- Families understand karma without fatalism or victim-blaming.
- Families practice responsible next-choice skills under real constraints.
- Families can discuss reincarnation calmly and compassionately.
- Families recognize the modes as changing influences, not labels.
- Families establish one boundary plus devotional shelter against an attention trap.

Memorization and recognition

Primary cycle verse: Bhagavad-gītā 3.9 or 18.63 according to family capacity. Recognition verses: BG 2.22, 14.5 and 7.14.

Protected off week

Week 7 is a complete off week. No meeting or make-up assignment. Families continue one selected Cycle 2 method only.

C2-W1 — Action and Reaction: How Karma Binds

Cycle 2 — Karma, Rebirth and Material Nature

Field	Detail
Week code	C2-W1
Cycle function	Foundational principle
Purpose	Introduce karma as the law by which materially motivated actions produce consequences and bind the living being, while showing that work offered for Viṣṇu can be purified.
Key verse	Bhagavad-gītā 3.9 — yajñārthāt karmaṇo 'nyatra ... karma-bandhanaḥ
Memory line	Work done only for separate material interest causes bondage; work done for Viṣṇu should be performed without selfish attachment.
Bhakti laboratory	Before—During—After Service Method
Minimum home practice	Use the before—during—after method once on a routine duty.

Learning Outcomes

Outcome domain	By the end of the session, participants should be able to...
Knowledge	- Define karma in this lesson as action and reaction under material nature, not merely fate or punishment. - Explain the distinction between ordinary action, prohibited action and action connected to Kṛṣṇa at an introductory level. - State that consequences may be immediate, delayed, visible or beyond our ability to trace.
Skill	- Analyze the intention, method and likely consequence of a family action. - Avoid claiming certainty about the karmic cause of another person's suffering.
Practice	Transform one routine duty by performing it carefully and offering the result to Kṛṣṇa.
Character	Accountability, foresight, honesty and compassion.
Child	- Understand that choices plant seeds and seeds produce results. - Name one action that helps and one action that harms.

Primary Śrīla Prabhupāda Sources

- Bhagavad-gītā 3.9
- Bhagavad-gītā 4.16–18
- Bhagavad-gītā 3.13
- Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Chapter 64 (King Nṛga), used selectively and age-appropriately

Key verse

Bhagavad-gītā 3.9

yajñārthāt karmaṇo 'nyatra ... karma-bandhanaḥ

Teaching memory line: Work done only for separate material interest causes bondage; work done for Viṣṇu should be performed without selfish attachment.

Prem-kī-Kathā Script

Delivery target: 8–10 minutes of scripted narration plus 5–7 minutes of interaction. Do not exceed the 20-minute block.

A parent sends a hurried message in anger. The message takes ten seconds to send, but the reaction continues for days. Trust is damaged, explanations multiply and the original issue becomes harder to solve. Another parent patiently repairs a child's school project. The child feels supported, yet the parent secretly expects praise and becomes resentful when none comes. Actions are not isolated dots. They carry intention, method and consequence.

Bhagavad-gītā 3.9 explains that work done without connection to sacrifice for Viṣṇu binds the worker. Kṛṣṇa does not tell Arjuna to stop all work. He teaches how action can be performed without becoming another chain. Karma is therefore not simply 'bad things happen because you were bad.' It is a vast law of action and reaction operating through material nature across time. We should apply it first to our own responsibility, not use it to explain someone else's pain.

The account of King Nrga gives a useful caution. He was charitable, yet through an error involving the same cow being given to two brāhmaṇas, a serious reaction followed. The lesson is not to fear service. It is that good intention does not remove the need for care, truth and correction. Material action is complex. Even respectable work can bind when mixed with error, proprietorship and unresolved harm.

A seed analogy helps. A seed may sprout quickly, much later or only under certain conditions. Once planted, it carries a tendency toward a corresponding fruit. We cannot inspect every fruit in another person's life and confidently name its seed. But we can become more careful about the seeds we plant now.

Devotional action changes the center. Cooking can be done for recognition, convenience or Kṛṣṇa. Earning can be done for status alone or used responsibly to maintain dependents and support service. Correcting a child can discharge anger or protect and educate. The visible act may look similar; consciousness and method matter.

This week choose one recurring duty. Before beginning, ask: Is this lawful and honest? Who may be affected? What result am I demanding? How can I perform it as service to Kṛṣṇa? That pause will not erase all past karma, but it begins training action away from bondage.

Parent Lesson — 40 Minutes

115. 0–5 min — Retrieval bridge from Cycle 1: if the soul is eternal, why do actions in a temporary body still matter?
116. 5–12 min — Read BG 3.9. Define action, reaction, bondage and yajña-centered work in plain language.
117. 12–20 min — Three-lens analysis: intention, method and consequence. Apply to cooking, earning, correction and online speech.
118. 20–28 min — King Nrga summary: good intention, procedural error, unresolved conflict and reaction. Avoid detailed cosmology.
119. 28–35 min — Case cards: truthful but harsh speech, generous gift for praise, careless service and difficult duty offered sincerely.
120. 35–40 min — Each adult writes one routine duty and a before–during–after service plan.

Children's Parallel Lesson — 40 Minutes

Common child timing: 0–5 opening/recall; 5–15 story or text; 15–28 movement, art, game or investigation; 28–35 verse/recall; 35–40 cleanup and family transition.

Age 4-6

- Plant two quick-growing seeds or use picture seeds; connect kind choices with helpful results.
- Action echo game: teacher names an action, children show a likely immediate result.
- Simple story: returning a borrowed item carefully versus losing it through carelessness.
- Recall: 'Choices are seeds. I want to plant service seeds.'

Age 7-9

- Seed–fruit matching cards, including delayed results such as practice leading to skill.
- Child-level King Nrga summary emphasizing care and correction, not fear.
- Analyze intention–method–result in three school or sibling situations.
- Choose one duty to do as an offering without asking for praise.

Age 10-13

- Read BG 3.9 and distinguish stopping work from changing its purpose.
- Discuss why good intention does not excuse dishonest or careless method.
- Challenge the statement: 'Every suffering person deserves what happened.'
- Create an action chain showing direct, indirect and delayed effects of one online post.

Analogy and Practical Example

Analogy • Actions are seeds: they carry tendencies toward corresponding fruits, although timing and conditions may be hidden.	Practical family example • A parent prepares prasāda for the group. The same task can produce resentment if done for comparison, carelessness if rushed, or purification when planned honestly, cooked cleanly and offered without demanding recognition.
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Questions: Discovery, Understanding and Application

Discovery

- What kind of work does BG 3.9 say causes bondage?
- What elements besides the visible act shape its moral and devotional quality?
- What did King Nrga's situation show about care and accountability?

Understanding

- Why is karma not identical to fatalism?
- Why can we not diagnose another person's suffering confidently?
- How does offering work to Kṛṣṇa differ from merely saying 'for Kṛṣṇa' after careless action?

Application

- Which routine action is most often driven by recognition, anger or haste?
- Who may be affected by that action?
- What specific change in intention or method will reduce bondage?

Bhakti Laboratory — Before–During–After Service Method

121. Choose one simple task: setting the prasāda area, arranging shoes or preparing class materials.
122. Before: state purpose, safety and who is served.
123. During: work carefully, cooperate and notice the demand for praise.
124. After: inspect the result, correct defects and offer gratitude.
125. Families identify which stage they usually skip.

Competency check

Participant can perform a simple duty through all three stages and explain how careful method is part of devotional intention.

Family Home Practice

Field	Detail
Minimum	Use the before–during–after method once on a routine duty.
Standard	Use it three times and note one reaction prevented by greater care.
Stretch	Repair one small unresolved consequence: apologize, return, replace, clarify or complete.
Evidence	Private action card; do not disclose sensitive conflicts in the group.

Slide Outline

126. The ten-second message and the long reaction
127. BG 3.9: action that binds and action for Viṣṇu
128. Karma is not simplistic punishment
129. Intention, method and consequence
130. King Nrga: care matters
131. The seed–fruit analogy
132. Do not diagnose another person's karma
133. Before–during–after service

134. Home action experiment

Teacher Preparation

- Read BG 3.9, 4.16–18 and the King Nṛga chapter; prepare a restrained summary.
- Do not present a complete taxonomy of karma, vikarma and akarma beyond the level supported by the lesson.
- Prepare scenarios that involve ordinary family responsibility rather than extreme tragedy.
- Brief teachers to stop victim-blaming language immediately and calmly.
- Prepare child-safe seed activity and check allergies if soil is used.

Required Materials

Materials A • Seed and fruit cards • Small pots or picture-seed set • Intention–method–consequence cards • Case cards	Materials B • Service task supplies • Action worksheets • Timer • Whiteboard
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Assessment

- Adult defines karma without reducing it to fate or revenge.
- Adult analyzes one case using intention, method and consequence.
- Child matches at least three actions with plausible results.
- Facilitator watches for fatalism and victim-blaming; mark for follow-up if present.

Newcomer Adaptation

KUTUMBA Setu application

Give a one-minute bridge: the soul continues, so choices have consequences beyond a single moment. Newcomers receive the seed analogy card and may choose a neutral household duty rather than discuss conflict.

Risks and Sensitive Points

- Never claim that illness, disability, abuse, disaster or poverty can be explained by a specific past action.
- Do not imply that devotional language cancels legal, ethical or practical consequences.
- Do not frighten children with punishment narratives.
- Avoid pretending that all reactions are visible or immediate.

Printable Worksheet — C2-W1

Action and Reaction: How Karma Binds

Key verse and memory line

Bhagavad-gītā 3.9

Work done only for separate material interest causes bondage; work done for Viṣṇu should be performed without selfish attachment.

Karma in this lesson means _____.

My chosen action: _____.

Intention: _____. Method: _____. People affected: _____.

Possible immediate result: _____. Possible delayed result: _____.

How I will connect it to Kṛṣṇa: before ____ during ____ after ____.

One repair I may need to make: _____.

This Week's Saṅkalpa

Specific action: _____

Day/time and trigger: _____

Minimum version: _____

How we will review it: _____

C2-W2 — Free Will and Responsibility: The Next Choice Matters

Cycle 2 — Karma, Rebirth and Material Nature

Field	Detail
Week code	C2-W2
Cycle function	Scriptural story and application
Purpose	Teach that the conditioned soul does not control every circumstance but retains meaningful, minute choice and responsibility, especially in how one responds to guidance, habits and present conditions.
Key verse	Bhagavad-gītā 18.63 — vimṛśyaitad aśeṣeṇa yathecchasi tathā kuru
Memory line	After giving knowledge, Kṛṣṇa tells Arjuna to deliberate fully and then act as he chooses.
Bhakti laboratory	Pause–Remember–Choose Practice
Minimum home practice	Use pause–remember–choose once daily on the chosen trigger.

Learning Outcomes

Outcome domain	By the end of the session, participants should be able to...
Knowledge	- Explain that material nature, prior conditioning, the body and other agents limit control. - State that Kṛṣṇa instructs Arjuna and then asks him to deliberate and choose. - Distinguish responsibility from total control and freedom from impulsiveness.
Skill	- Separate what is controlled, influenced and not controlled in a difficult situation. - Use a pause–remember–choose method before reacting.
Practice	Apply the three-step choice pause to one predictable trigger each day.
Character	Responsibility, courage, patience and willingness to seek guidance.
Child	- Understand that feelings can be strong while choices still matter. - Use a simple stop–remember–choose routine.

Primary Śrīla Prabhupāda Sources

- Bhagavad-gītā 18.61–63, especially 18.63
- Bhagavad-gītā 3.33–34
- Bhagavad-gītā 5.14–15
- Bhagavad-gītā 2.7 and 18.73 (Arjuna seeks guidance and chooses)

Key verse

Bhagavad-gītā 18.63

vimṛśyaitad aśeṣeṇa yathecchasi tathā kuru

Teaching memory line: After giving knowledge, Kṛṣṇa tells Arjuna to deliberate fully and then act as he chooses.

Prem-kī-Kathā Script

Delivery target: 8–10 minutes of scripted narration plus 5–7 minutes of interaction. Do not exceed the 20-minute block.

Two statements often appear in the same home. First: 'I had no choice; you made me angry.' Second: 'I should be able to control everything if I am spiritual.' Both are inaccurate. We do not control every circumstance, body, emotion, other person or result. But we are not merely helpless machines either.

Arjuna stands in a situation he did not design. Family loyalties, social duty, fear, grief and the momentum of history press upon him. Kṛṣṇa explains reality, action, devotion and surrender. Then in Bhagavad-gītā 18.63, Kṛṣṇa tells Arjuna to deliberate fully and act as he chooses. Guidance does not erase choice; it makes responsible choice possible. Arjuna later says that his illusion is dispelled and he will act according to Kṛṣṇa's instruction.

Conditioning is real. Bhagavad-gītā 3.33–34 explains that embodied beings act according to nature and experience attraction and aversion. A tired parent, anxious child or habit-driven mind does not begin from a perfectly neutral place. That explains difficulty; it does not make every reaction acceptable. Our freedom is minute but meaningful: whom we hear from, whether we pause, whether we tell the truth, whether we ask for help and whether we repeat or repair.

Imagine sailing. We do not control the wind, current or weather. We do control whether we study the chart, adjust the sail, maintain the boat and heed an experienced guide. Claiming total control is arrogance. Throwing away the rudder is fatalism. Devotional responsibility means using the small rudder while depending on Kṛṣṇa.

When triggered, use three steps. Pause: stop the immediate reaction if safety allows. Remember: 'I am a servant, not the center; Kṛṣṇa's instruction matters.' Choose: identify the next truthful, non-harmful action. Sometimes the choice is to speak. Sometimes it is to become quiet, leave temporarily, seek help or apologize.

This week choose one predictable trigger—phone distraction, sibling conflict, criticism, late arrival or food craving. You may not control the first feeling. Train the next choice. That is where responsibility becomes practical.

Parent Lesson — 40 Minutes

135. 0–5 min — Control circle: write one current concern and sort elements into control, influence and no control.
136. 5–12 min — Read BG 18.63 and 18.73. Note instruction, deliberation, choice and willing alignment.
137. 12–18 min — Brief reading of BG 3.33–34. Discuss conditioning without excusing harmful behavior.
138. 18–28 min — Trigger chain: event → body sensation → thought → urge → choice → consequence. Map a low-risk example.
139. 28–35 min — Practice pause–remember–choose in pairs using prepared scenarios.
140. 35–40 min — Select one trigger and design an environmental support: reminder card, delay, device boundary or help request.

Children's Parallel Lesson — 40 Minutes

Common child timing: 0–5 opening/recall; 5–15 story or text; 15–28 movement, art, game or investigation; 28–35 verse/recall; 35–40 cleanup and family transition.

Age 4-6

- Traffic-light routine: red stop, yellow remember Kṛṣṇa and the rule, green choose a safe action.
- Puppet scenario: toy taken, strong anger, two possible choices.
- Body signal game: identify tight fists, loud voice and fast breathing as signals to pause.
- Practice asking an adult for help.

Age 7-9

- Arjuna choice story: confused, asks Kṛṣṇa, hears, thinks and acts.
- Control/influence/no-control sorting with school and family situations.
- Traffic-light role plays with a respectful redo after an unhelpful choice.
- Create a pocket pause card.

Age 10-13

- Read BG 18.63 and discuss whether choice means 'do whatever you feel.'
- Map one digital habit trigger and identify the smallest point of intervention.
- Discuss coercion, peer pressure and when to seek a trusted adult rather than manage alone.
- Write a choice statement: 'I cannot control ____; I can choose ____.'

Analogy and Practical Example

Analogy Free will is like a small rudder on a boat: it does not control wind and current, but abandoning it changes the journey.	Practical family example A child refuses bedtime. The parent cannot instantly control the child's mood, but can lower voice, repeat the boundary, offer two acceptable choices and avoid turning frustration into humiliation.
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Questions: Discovery, Understanding and Application

Discovery

- What does Kṛṣṇa tell Arjuna to do before choosing?
- What factors influence conditioned behavior?
- What choice does Arjuna make in BG 18.73?

Understanding

- Why is responsibility not the same as controlling every result?
- How can conditioning explain behavior without excusing harm?
- Why does good guidance strengthen rather than remove freedom?

Application

- What trigger repeatedly narrows your choices?
- What signal tells you to pause?
- What is one safe next choice and one support you will use?

Bhakti Laboratory — Pause–Remember–Choose Practice

141. Teach a physical pause signal: hand to heart or touching a pocket card.
142. Remember one line: 'I am Kṛṣṇa's servant; choose truth and care.'
143. Offer two or three acceptable next actions for each scenario.
144. Role-play once, receive one correction and repeat successfully.
145. For unsafe situations, the correct choice is immediate adult help or leaving—not quiet endurance.

Competency check

Participant can interrupt one trigger chain and name a safer, more devotional next action.

Family Home Practice

Field	Detail
Minimum	Use pause–remember–choose once daily on the chosen trigger.
Standard	Track trigger, first urge and chosen action for three days.
Stretch	Repair one poor choice within twenty-four hours through apology, correction or restitution.
Evidence	Private three-line log; no one must reveal sensitive family conflict.

Slide Outline

146. 'You made me' versus 'I control everything'
147. BG 18.63: hear, deliberate, choose
148. Arjuna's guided decision
149. Conditioning is real
150. Responsibility remains
151. The small-rudder analogy
152. Trigger chain
153. Pause–remember–choose
154. Home trigger experiment

Teacher Preparation

- Read BG 18.61–63, 18.73, 3.33–34 and 5.14–15 with purports.
- Prepare low-risk scenarios; do not invite public disclosure of abuse, addiction or severe conflict.
- Brief volunteers on mandatory safety escalation: a child's request for help is not merely a self-regulation exercise.
- Prepare traffic-light cards and control-circle sheets.
- Avoid presenting free will as unlimited independence from Kṛṣṇa or nature.

Required Materials

Materials A • Traffic-light cards • Puppets • Control-circle sheets • Trigger-chain cards • Pocket pause cards	Materials B • Scenario cards • Pencils • Timer • Whiteboard
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Assessment

- Adult correctly separates control, influence and no control.
- Adult demonstrates pause–remember–choose in one scenario.
- Child uses traffic-light steps and identifies when adult help is needed.
- Teacher notes whether participants drift toward blame or helplessness.

Newcomer Adaptation

KUTUMBA Setu application

Provide the action–reaction seed card from the previous week, then explain that today focuses on the next available choice. Newcomers may use a neutral trigger such as phone checking.

Risks and Sensitive Points

- Do not tell victims they freely chose the harm done to them.
- Do not use free-will teaching to avoid safeguarding, professional help or legal responsibility.
- Do not shame neurodivergent or emotionally dysregulated children; add support and smaller steps.
- Do not imply that one pause guarantees a desired outcome.

Printable Worksheet — C2-W2

Free Will and Responsibility: The Next Choice Matters

Key verse and memory line

Bhagavad-gītā 18.63

After giving knowledge, Kṛṣṇa tells Arjuna to deliberate fully and then act as he chooses.

Situation: _____.

What I control: _____. What I influence: _____. What I do not control: _____.

My body signal: _____. My usual urge: _____.

Pause action: _____. Remember line: _____.

Two acceptable choices: 1) ____ 2) ____.

If I choose poorly, my repair will be _____.

This Week's Saṅkalpa

Specific action: _____

Day/time and trigger: _____

Minimum version: _____

How we will review it: _____

C2-W3 — Birth, Death and Reincarnation

Cycle 2 — Karma, Rebirth and Material Nature

Field	Detail
Week code	C2-W3
Cycle function	Practical worldview laboratory
Purpose	Teach transmigration as the soul's movement through changing bodies under karma and consciousness, in a calm and age-appropriate way that supports responsibility and spiritual hope rather than fear or speculation.
Key verse	Bhagavad-gītā 2.22 — vāsāṁsi jīrṇāni yathā vihāya
Memory line	As a person puts aside worn clothes and accepts new ones, the soul leaves an old body and receives another.
Bhakti laboratory	Bedtime Remembrance Routine
Minimum home practice	Complete the one-minute bedtime remembrance three nights.

Learning Outcomes

Outcome domain	By the end of the session, participants should be able to...
Knowledge	- Explain reincarnation using BG 2.13 and the clothes analogy of BG 2.22. - State that death ends a particular body, not the eternal soul. - Recognize that consciousness, karma and Kṛṣṇa's supervision are involved, while avoiding claims about a specific person's next birth.
Skill	- Answer a basic question about death with truth, calmness and developmental sensitivity. - Use the clothes analogy while naming its limit: changing bodies is not a casual choice under our present control.
Practice	End the day with one minute of Kṛṣṇa remembrance rather than uncontrolled media.
Character	Sobriety, hope, compassion and reduced denial of mortality.
Child	- Understand that the soul continues when the body stops working. - Know that questions and feelings about death are allowed and should be brought to trusted adults.

Primary Śrīla Prabhupāda Sources

- Bhagavad-gītā 2.13
- Bhagavad-gītā 2.20 and 2.22
- Bhagavad-gītā 2.27
- Bhagavad-gītā 8.5–6
- Bhagavad-gītā 14.14–15, introduced only at recognition level

Key verse

Bhagavad-gītā 2.22

vāsāṁsi jīrṇāni yathā vihāya

Teaching memory line: As a person puts aside worn clothes and accepts new ones, the soul leaves an old body and receives

another.

Prem-kī-Kathā Script

Delivery target: 8–10 minutes of scripted narration plus 5–7 minutes of interaction. Do not exceed the 20-minute block.

A child asks at bedtime, ‘What happens when someone dies?’ Adults often move toward one of two extremes. We may avoid the question because it is uncomfortable, or give a frightening amount of detail because we think philosophy requires bluntness. Kṛṣṇa gives a sober middle path: the body changes and ends, but the soul is not destroyed.

Bhagavad-gītā 2.13 begins with changes we already observe—childhood, youth and old age—and then extends the principle to another body at death. Bhagavad-gītā 2.22 compares the change to putting aside worn clothes and accepting new ones. The analogy gives hope, but it should not be made casual. We do not presently select bodies as easily as clothing. Material nature, karma, consciousness and the Lord’s supervision shape the next condition.

Bhagavad-gītā 8.6 teaches that remembrance and absorption influence the next destination. This is not an invitation to panic about a single passing thought. It is a reason to shape the direction of life. What we repeatedly hear, desire, practice and serve forms consciousness. Daily remembrance matters because final remembrance grows from lived habits.

For a grieving person, philosophy should not become a weapon. We do not say, ‘Do not cry; the soul is eternal.’ Arjuna knew spiritual truths and still experienced grief. We can say, ‘The relationship mattered. The body is gone, and that hurts. Kṛṣṇa teaches that the soul continues. Let us remember, pray and seek shelter.’ Truth and compassion belong together.

Think of moving from one room to another while the person remains. We may no longer see the person in the first room, and the separation is real for those left there. The analogy is imperfect, but it helps children understand continuity without graphic detail.

This week, protect the last minute before sleep. Put down the device. Chant, hear one name of Kṛṣṇa, look toward the altar or offer a simple prayer. We are training the direction of consciousness one evening at a time.

Parent Lesson — 40 Minutes

155. 0–5 min — Anonymous question box: participants may submit a question about death or reincarnation without discussion of personal loss.
156. 5–13 min — Read BG 2.13 and 2.22. Identify continuity, change and analogy limits.
157. 13–20 min — Read the memory line from BG 8.6. Explain life-direction and repeated consciousness rather than superstition about one thought.
158. 20–30 min — Response practice: answer a five-year-old, ten-year-old and grieving adult in two or three sentences.
159. 30–35 min — Misconception check: ghost stories, choosing any next body, guessing a deceased person’s destination and minimizing grief.
160. 35–40 min — Design a one-minute bedtime remembrance practice.

Children’s Parallel Lesson — 40 Minutes

Common child timing: 0–5 opening/recall; 5–15 story or text; 15–28 movement, art, game or investigation; 28–35 verse/recall; 35–40 cleanup and family transition.

Age 4-6

- Use a doll with changeable clothes: the doll/person stays while clothes change; explain simply that the soul stays while bodies change.
- Read a gentle original story about a caterpillar leaving one stage and continuing, while noting it is only a picture, not proof.
- Feelings cards: sad, confused, peaceful, worried. All can be shared with a trusted adult.
- Practice a bedtime prayer: ‘Kṛṣṇa, please help me remember You.’

Age 7-9

- Sequence BG 2.13: baby, child, adult, old body, another body.
- Clothes analogy and its limit: bodies are not chosen from a closet.
- Question sorting: what scripture tells us, what we can infer and what we should not guess.
- Create a remembrance card for bedtime.

Age 10-13

- Compare BG 2.13, 2.20 and 2.22 in a three-column chart.
- Discuss how repeated media, desires and habits shape consciousness.
- Analyze compassionate and uncompassionate responses to grief.

- Prepare a two-sentence answer to 'Why should present choices matter if the soul continues?'

Analogy and Practical Example

Analogy • Changing bodies is compared to changing worn clothes; the analogy shows continuity of the wearer, but not unrestricted control over the next body.	Practical family example • After a pet dies, a parent says: 'We are sad because we cared for this living being. Kṛṣṇa teaches that the soul continues. We do not know the soul's next situation, so we will not invent a story. We can pray and remember the care we shared.'
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Questions: Discovery, Understanding and Application

Discovery

- What changes are named before death in BG 2.13?
- What continues in BG 2.20?
- What comparison is used in BG 2.22?

Understanding

- Why is the clothing analogy helpful and limited?
- How does repeated consciousness relate to future direction?
- Why should grief be respected even when the soul is eternal?

Application

- What fills the final minutes of your day now?
- What simple remembrance can replace one minute of distraction?
- How will you answer a child without fear or false certainty?

Bhakti Laboratory — Bedtime Remembrance Routine

161. Choose a fixed cue: device charging, teeth brushing or entering the bedroom.
162. Sit or stand safely before the sacred space or a clean image.
163. Chant the mahā-mantra once slowly or hear a short approved recording.
164. Name one gratitude and one request for remembrance.
165. End without extending into a lecture or forced emotional sharing.

Competency check

Family can perform a calm one-minute remembrance routine suitable for children.

Family Home Practice

Field	Detail
Minimum	Complete the one-minute bedtime remembrance three nights.
Standard	Complete it five nights and reduce device use for the final five minutes.
Stretch	Read BG 2.22 together once and discuss the analogy's limit.
Evidence	Private check marks; no reporting of grief stories.

Slide Outline

166. A child asks about death
167. BG 2.13: continuity through change
168. BG 2.20: the soul is not destroyed
169. BG 2.22: worn clothes
170. What shapes future consciousness
171. What we do not claim
172. Truth plus compassion in grief

173. Bedtime remembrance

174. Home practice

Teacher Preparation

- Read the assigned verses and prepare only the level needed for foundational teaching.
- Check whether any participating family has a recent bereavement; offer an opt-out or private warning.
- Prepare gentle materials; no graphic images, frightening stories or public testimony requests.
- Brief teachers not to interpret dreams, paranormal claims or a specific person's rebirth.
- Have a plan to refer intense grief or trauma to appropriate pastoral or professional support.

Required Materials

Materials A	Materials B
• Doll and changeable clothes • Life-stage cards • Feelings cards • Question sorting cards	• Bedtime reminder cards • Verse comparison sheets • Pencils • Soft timer or bell

Assessment

- Adult explains reincarnation using continuity and change without speculation.
- Adult gives a compassionate response that allows grief.
- Child states that the soul continues and knows to ask a trusted adult.
- No public quiz about destinations, species or personal deceased relatives.

Newcomer Adaptation

KUTUMBA Setu application

Give the Cycle 1 body–soul summary before class. New families may skip personal questions and simply learn the clothes analogy plus bedtime remembrance.

Risks and Sensitive Points

- This topic can trigger grief or fear; never force participation.
- Do not predict a next birth or explain a death through karma.
- Do not use fear of lower birth to control children.
- Do not suppress healthy mourning with philosophy.

Printable Worksheet — C2-W3

Birth, Death and Reincarnation

Key verse and memory line

Bhagavad-gītā 2.22

As a person puts aside worn clothes and accepts new ones, the soul leaves an old body and receives another.

BG 2.13 teaches continuity through _____.

BG 2.20 teaches that the soul _____.

BG 2.22 compares bodies to _____.

The analogy helps because _____. Its limit is _____.

My bedtime cue: _____. My one-minute remembrance: _____.

A compassionate sentence I can use: _____.

This Week's Saṅkalpa

Specific action: _____

Day/time and trigger: _____

Minimum version: _____

How we will review it: _____

C2-W4 — The Three Modes of Material Nature

Cycle 2 — Karma, Rebirth and Material Nature

Field	Detail
Week code	C2-W4
Cycle function	Parent and child formation
Purpose	Introduce goodness, passion and ignorance as changing influences that condition perception and behavior, while preventing fixed labels and directing families toward habits favorable for bhakti.
Key verse	Bhagavad-gītā 14.5 — sattvaṁ rajas tama iti guṇāḥ prakṛti-sambhavāḥ
Memory line	Material nature has three modes—goodness, passion and ignorance—that condition the eternal living being.
Bhakti laboratory	Clarity Before Chanting
Minimum home practice	Complete one five-minute environment reset before family chanting or reading.

Learning Outcomes

Outcome domain	By the end of the session, participants should be able to...
Knowledge	- Name sattva, rajas and tamas and describe their basic tendencies. - Explain that the modes mix, change and bind the living entity; they are not permanent identities. - Recognize that even goodness can bind through attachment to happiness and knowledge.
Skill	- Identify mode-like influences in an environment, habit or decision without labeling a person. - Redesign one evening routine toward clarity and devotional practice.
Practice	Complete one 'clarity before chanting' routine this week.
Character	Discernment, moderation, orderliness and compassion.
Child	- Identify calm/clear, restless/grabbing and dull/confused patterns in simple situations. - Choose one habit that supports clarity and kindness.

Primary Śrīla Prabhupāda Sources

- Bhagavad-gītā 14.5–9
- Bhagavad-gītā 14.17–18
- Bhagavad-gītā 17.8–10, used carefully for general food tendencies rather than policing families
- Bhagavad-gītā 14.26

Key verse

Bhagavad-gītā 14.5

sattvaṁ rajas tama iti guṇāḥ prakṛti-sambhavāḥ

Teaching memory line: Material nature has three modes—goodness, passion and ignorance—that condition the eternal living being.

Prem-kī-Kathā Script

Delivery target: 8–10 minutes of scripted narration plus 5–7 minutes of interaction. Do not exceed the 20-minute block.

The same family can experience three very different evenings. On one evening, the room is reasonably clean, the meal is timely, voices are calm and a short reading feels possible. On another, everyone is rushing, several screens are active, plans keep changing and irritation rises. On a third, dishes remain for days, people oversleep, avoid responsibility and feel too dull to begin anything.

Bhagavad-gītā describes three modes of material nature: goodness, passion and ignorance. Goodness brings relative clarity, knowledge and happiness. Passion brings intense desire, activity, competition and dissatisfaction. Ignorance brings darkness, confusion, negligence and inertia. These modes mix. A person may be clear in one area, restless in another and dull when exhausted.

The modes are influences, not insults. Saying ‘You are tamasic’ freezes a person into a label and usually produces pride in the speaker. A better question is: ‘Which influence is shaping this moment, and what action would make hearing and service easier?’ The soul is beyond the modes by nature, although conditioned by them.

Imagine three colored filters placed over a clear lamp. The lamp remains the source, but the environment appears different through each filter. The analogy is limited—the soul is not simply shining independently while unaffected—but it shows that conditioning alters perception and behavior.

Goodness is useful because it supports clarity, truth and discipline, yet it is not the final goal. One can become proud of being clean, knowledgeable or controlled. Bhagavad-gītā 14.26 directs us beyond the modes through steady devotional service. KUTUMBA therefore does not become a lifestyle competition. We cultivate favorable conditions so we can hear, chant and serve.

This week redesign one evening. Reduce one agitating input, remove one source of disorder, choose a suitable meal and begin the devotional practice before everyone is exhausted. Do not label the family. Change the conditions.

Parent Lesson — 40 Minutes

175. 0–5 min — Observe three room images: calm/ordered, overstimulated and neglected. Describe conditions, not people.
176. 5–14 min — Read BG 14.5–9 in summarized form. Build a three-column tendency chart.
177. 14–20 min — Explain mixing and change; discuss how fatigue, media, food, company and time of day influence behavior.
178. 20–29 min — Scenario analysis: study session, temple service, shopping, family argument and weekend sleep. Identify dominant influences and one elevating action.
179. 29–35 min — Goodness trap: pride, comfort attachment and judging others. Connect to BG 14.26.
180. 35–40 min — Redesign one evening routine using remove, add, move earlier and simplify.

Children’s Parallel Lesson — 40 Minutes

Common child timing: 0–5 opening/recall; 5–15 story or text; 15–28 movement, art, game or investigation; 28–35 verse/recall; 35–40 cleanup and family transition.

Age 4-6

- Three weather faces: clear sky, windy storm and dark fog. Match simple behaviors without calling children a mode.
- Room reset game: tidy three items, lower noise and sit for one chant.
- Food picture discussion focused on freshness and moderation, not shame.
- Recall: ‘I can choose habits that help me hear Kṛṣṇa.’

Age 7-9

- Mode detectives: identify clues in short stories and suggest one better choice.
- Colored-filter lamp demonstration.
- Create a before-bed clarity checklist: tidy, wash, reduce screen, chant, sleep.
- Discuss why people can change and should not be labeled.

Age 10-13

- Read BG 14.5 and summarize each mode in one sentence.
- Analyze an algorithm-driven media feed for passion and ignorance influences.
- Discuss how goodness can create superiority.
- Design a two-hour evening environment that supports school duties and bhakti.

Analogy and Practical Example

Analogy The modes are like colored filters affecting how a situation appears; change the filter conditions rather than confusing the filter with the eternal self.	Practical family example Instead of calling a child lazy, a parent notices late bedtime, a cluttered room and an overwhelming task. The parent reduces the task, removes the device, works beside the child for five minutes and restores a clear routine.
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Questions: Discovery, Understanding and Application

Discovery

- What three modes are named in BG 14.5?
- What tendencies are associated with each?
- What does BG 14.26 say about transcending the modes?

Understanding

- Why should modes describe influences rather than fixed people?
- How can goodness still bind?
- Why is environmental design spiritually relevant?

Application

- Which input most agitates your home?
- Which neglected condition makes practice harder?
- What will you remove, add, move earlier or simplify?

Bhakti Laboratory — Clarity Before Chanting

181. Compare a noisy, cluttered setup with a simple clean setup.
182. Families perform a five-minute reset: put away items, wash hands, silence devices and arrange seating.
183. Lead three minutes of attentive mahā-mantra response chanting.
184. Reflect: which physical changes altered attention?
185. Clarify that external goodness supports bhakti but is not itself pure devotion.

Competency check

Family can prepare a basic environment that reduces agitation and negligence before hearing or chanting.

Family Home Practice

Field	Detail
Minimum	Complete one five-minute environment reset before family chanting or reading.
Standard	Redesign one evening using remove, add, move earlier and simplify.
Stretch	Track energy and attention before and after the routine for three evenings.
Evidence	Private rating of clarity from 1–5; no family ranking.

Slide Outline

186. Three different evenings
187. BG 14.5: the three modes
188. Goodness, passion and ignorance
189. Modes mix and change
190. Do not label people
191. The colored-filter analogy
192. The goodness trap
193. BG 14.26: devotion beyond the modes

194. Evening redesign

Teacher Preparation

- Read BG 14.5–9, 14.17–18 and 14.26 with purports.
- Prepare mode descriptions as tendencies, not personality tests.
- Avoid cultural, gender, class or mental-health stereotypes.
- Use food examples cautiously; do not police allergies, medical diets or family budgets.
- Prepare room images, safe colored filters and reset materials.

Required Materials

Materials A • Room images • Colored transparent sheets and LED lamp • Mode tendency cards • Scenario cards	Materials B • Reset basket • Device basket or mock phones • Evening-planning sheets • Timer
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Assessment

- Adult names the three modes and one tendency of each.
- Adult analyzes a condition without labeling a person.
- Child chooses an elevating habit in two scenarios.
- Facilitator corrects superiority or food-shaming immediately.

Newcomer Adaptation

KUTUMBA Setu application

Give the one-page mode chart and explain that it describes changing material influences. Newcomers join the environment reset without needing prior karma lessons.

Risks and Sensitive Points

- Never call a person, family, culture, gender or diagnosis ‘a mode.’
- Do not treat sattva as spiritual perfection or a basis for superiority.
- Do not turn food discussion into medical advice or public inspection.
- Do not shame exhausted caregivers; redesign within real constraints.

Printable Worksheet — C2-W4

The Three Modes of Material Nature

Key verse and memory line

Bhagavad-gītā 14.5

Material nature has three modes—goodness, passion and ignorance—that condition the eternal living being.

Goodness tends toward _____. Passion tends toward _____. Ignorance tends toward _____.

A condition in our home that increases agitation: _____.

A condition that increases dullness or neglect: _____.

Remove: ____ Add: ____ Move earlier: ____ Simplify: ____.

How this supports bhakti rather than pride: _____.

Child box: Circle the habits that help you hear clearly.

This Week's Saṅkalpa

Specific action: _____

Day/time and trigger: _____

Minimum version: _____

How we will review it: _____

C2-W5 — Māyā: Decorating the Prison Cell

Cycle 2 — Karma, Rebirth and Material Nature

Field	Detail
Week code	C2-W5
Cycle function	Case study and practical application
Purpose	Teach māyā as Kṛṣṇa's difficult-to-overcome material energy that covers and misdirects the conditioned soul, while showing surrender, association and devotional practice as the way through—not hatred of the world or of women.
Key verse	Bhagavad-gītā 7.14 — daivī hy eṣā guṇa-mayī mama māyā duratyayā
Memory line	Kṛṣṇa's material energy is difficult to overcome, but those who surrender to Him can cross beyond it.
Bhakti laboratory	Attention Boundary and Japa Shelter
Minimum home practice	Use one media or consumption boundary for three days.

Learning Outcomes

Outcome domain	By the end of the session, participants should be able to...
Knowledge	- Explain māyā as divine material energy that binds through the three modes and makes misidentification and misplaced attraction appear natural. - State that the problem is not responsible material arrangement but forgetting the purpose and proprietor. - Identify surrender to Kṛṣṇa as the path beyond māyā.
Skill	- Recognize one attention trap and name the false promise it makes. - Use stop–name–redirect to interrupt an attachment loop.
Practice	Create one concrete boundary around media, consumption or recognition-seeking.
Character	Vigilance, humility, simplicity and dependence on Kṛṣṇa.
Child	- Understand that something can look attractive yet pull us away from what matters. - Know that 'māyā' is never a name to insult a woman, child or ordinary responsibility.

Primary Śrīla Prabhupāda Sources

- Bhagavad-gītā 7.14
- Bhagavad-gītā 2.62–63
- Bhagavad-gītā 15.7
- Bhagavad-gītā 9.10
- Śrīla Prabhupāda's recurring 'decorating the prison cell' analogy, used as an analogy rather than a direct quotation exercise

Key verse

Bhagavad-gītā 7.14

daivī hy eṣā guṇa-mayī mama māyā duratyayā

Teaching memory line: Kṛṣṇa's material energy is difficult to overcome, but those who surrender to Him can cross beyond it.

Prem-kī-Kathā Script

Delivery target: 8–10 minutes of scripted narration plus 5–7 minutes of interaction. Do not exceed the 20-minute block.

A person receives a notification while reading Bhagavad-gītā. 'I will check for ten seconds,' the mind says. Twenty minutes later, the person has moved through messages, news, shopping and comparison, and can barely remember the verse. Nothing forced the hand physically. Yet the sequence felt automatic.

Bhagavad-gītā 7.14 describes the material energy as divine, made of the three modes and very difficult to overcome. Māyā does not mean that the world has no existence or that every ordinary object is evil. It means that Kṛṣṇa's energy covers the living being when we see ourselves as independent enjoyers and forget our relationship with Him.

Bhagavad-gītā 2.62–63 gives a practical chain: contemplation develops attachment, attachment develops desire, frustrated desire produces anger and the sequence damages judgment. Māyā often works through repeated attention. What we keep looking at begins to look necessary. What looks necessary begins to command us.

Śrīla Prabhupāda used the image of decorating a prison cell. Cleanliness and responsible arrangement are not condemned. The foolishness is to spend the entire life improving the cell while forgetting release. A comfortable home, education, career and technology can all support service. They become prison decoration when treated as the ultimate project and proprietor identity.

Māyā must never be used as a slur for women. In devotional philosophy, the material energy is Kṛṣṇa's energy; women and men are both souls who can be conditioned or devoted. Calling a spouse, child or woman 'māyā' is ignorance and disrespect.

The verse does not end with defeat. Those who surrender to Kṛṣṇa cross beyond this energy. Use three steps this week. Stop the loop. Name the false promise—'This will make me important, safe or satisfied.' Redirect toward a concrete devotional action: chant, contact a devotee, complete duty, move the device or offer the desire honestly to Kṛṣṇa. Māyā is strong; private willpower alone is a weak plan. Build shelter.

Parent Lesson — 40 Minutes

195. 0–5 min — Attention snapshot: which item receives the first and last attention of the day? Private response.
196. 5–12 min — Read BG 7.14. Identify whose energy māyā is, what it consists of and how it is crossed.
197. 12–20 min — Map BG 2.62–63 as an attention-to-judgment chain using a non-sensitive example.
198. 20–28 min — Prison-cell case study: good householder responsibility versus making comfort, image or control the ultimate project.
199. 28–34 min — Explicit correction exercise: why 'women are māyā' is philosophically and ethically false.
200. 34–40 min — Design one boundary plus one shelter: device location, shopping delay, praise fast, japa buddy or mentor check-in.

Children's Parallel Lesson — 40 Minutes

Common child timing: 0–5 opening/recall; 5–15 story or text; 15–28 movement, art, game or investigation; 28–35 verse/recall; 35–40 cleanup and family transition.

Age 4-6

- Shiny-choice puppet: a flashing toy distracts from helping; children practice stop and choose.
- Sticky-note path: each repeated look adds a note until the path is hard to leave.
- Say clearly: 'People are not māyā. Māyā is the energy that makes us forget Kṛṣṇa.'
- Redirect action: put down, take three breaths, chant once, choose help.

Age 7-9

- Attention chain cards based on BG 2.62–63.
- Decorated-cage analogy: a beautiful cage is still not the bird's freedom; discuss limits respectfully.
- Identify false promises in toy, game and popularity advertisements.
- Create one home device boundary with parents.

Age 10-13

- Read BG 7.14 and map surrender as the exit rather than mere self-control.
- Analyze a recommendation algorithm as an engineered attention loop.
- Discuss how spiritual language can be misused to demean women or avoid responsibility.
- Create stop-name-redirect plans for one personal trap.

Analogy and Practical Example

Analogy Decorating a prison cell can improve comfort without solving captivity; material arrangements should support liberation and service, not replace the goal.	Practical family example A parent repeatedly buys devotional items but has no reading or chanting routine. The correction is not to condemn the items. It is to pause purchases for a month and use what is already present in actual family practice.
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Questions: Discovery, Understanding and Application

Discovery

- How does BG 7.14 describe māyā?
- What sequence begins with contemplation in BG 2.62–63?
- What action is named as the way to cross māyā?

Understanding

- Why is māyā not equal to ‘the world is fake’?
- When does responsible material arrangement become prison decoration?
- Why is calling women ‘māyā’ wrong?

Application

- Which attention loop most often steals your intended devotional time?
- What false promise does it make?
- What boundary and devotional shelter will you add?

Bhakti Laboratory — Attention Boundary and Japa Shelter

- Place phones outside reach or use mock devices for the demonstration.
- Write one false promise on paper and turn it face down.
- Chant attentively for five minutes with a clear beginning and end.
- After chanting, identify one practical boundary: charging location, app limit, no-device sacred space or delayed purchase.
- Pair each boundary with shelter: replacement practice, family support or devotee accountability.

Competency check

Participant creates a specific boundary and replacement shelter rather than relying on vague willpower.

Family Home Practice

Field	Detail
Minimum	Use one media or consumption boundary for three days.
Standard	Use stop–name–redirect each time the chosen loop begins.
Stretch	Complete a twenty-four-hour pause from one nonessential app, purchase or praise-seeking behavior and redirect the time to service.
Evidence	Private note of trigger, false promise and redirected action.

Slide Outline

- The ten-second notification
- BG 7.14: divine energy and surrender
- BG 2.62–63: the attention chain
- What māyā means—and does not mean
- Decorating the prison cell
- Responsible life versus ultimate absorption
- Women are not ‘māyā’
- Stop–name–redirect

214. Boundary plus shelter

Teacher Preparation

- Read BG 7.14 and 2.62–63 with purports; prepare precise definitions.
- Confirm all teachers will explicitly reject misogynistic misuse of the term māyā.
- Prepare age-appropriate media examples without displaying inappropriate content.
- Avoid public disclosure of addiction or compulsive behavior; offer private support pathways.
- Prepare device-boundary cards and a five-minute chanting plan.

Required Materials

Materials A	Materials B
• Mock phones or device basket • Attention-chain cards • Decorated-cage image or model • Advertisement cards	• Boundary cards • Japa beads • Paper and pens • Timer

Assessment

- Adult defines māyā without saying women or matter itself are evil.
- Adult maps one attention chain and designs boundary plus shelter.
- Child states that people are souls and not to be called māyā.
- Facilitator checks whether the plan includes a replacement, not only prohibition.

Newcomer Adaptation

KUTUMBA Setu application

Provide the three-modes summary and explain that māyā works through those influences. New families may select a simple no-phone sacred-space boundary.

Risks and Sensitive Points

- Explicitly prohibit misogynistic use of 'māyā.'
- Do not treat mental illness, addiction or trauma as merely weak chanting.
- Do not condemn necessary technology, employment, housing or family care.
- Do not create public device inspections or shame-based confessions.

Printable Worksheet — C2-W5

Māyā: Decorating the Prison Cell

Key verse and memory line

Bhagavad-gītā 7.14

Kṛṣṇa's material energy is difficult to overcome, but those who surrender to Him can cross beyond it.

My attention trap: _____.

The false promise it makes: 'If I do/get/check this, then _____.'

BG 2.62–63 chain in my case: attention ____ attachment ____ desire ____ reaction ____.

My boundary: _____.

My replacement shelter: chanting / reading / service / devotee contact / other _____.

Truth to remember: People are not māyā because _____.

This Week's Saṅkalpa

Specific action: _____

Day/time and trigger: _____

Minimum version: _____

How we will review it: _____

C2-W6 — Integration Night: Choice, Consequence and the Modes

Cycle 2 — Karma, Rebirth and Material Nature

Field	Detail
Week code	C2-W6
Cycle function	Family case-study night and assessed application
Purpose	Consolidate karma, responsibility, reincarnation, modes and māyā through family decisions, scenario analysis and one practical redesign plan.
Key verse	Bhagavad-gītā 18.63 — vimṛśyaitad ... yatheccchasi tathā kuru
Memory line	Knowledge should lead to thoughtful, responsible choice under Kṛṣṇa's guidance.
Bhakti laboratory	Five-Lens Family Case Lab
Minimum home practice	Continue one selected Cycle 2 method during the off week.

Learning Outcomes

Outcome domain	By the end of the session, participants should be able to...
Knowledge	- Connect action, choice, conditioning, consequence and future consciousness in a coherent sequence. - Recognize BG 3.9, BG 18.63, BG 2.22, BG 14.5 and BG 7.14.
Skill	- Analyze a family case without blame, fatalism or fixed labels. - Propose a next action that includes responsibility, environmental design and shelter in Kṛṣṇa.
Practice	Choose one Cycle 2 method to continue: before–during–after, choice pause, bedtime remembrance, clarity reset or boundary plus shelter.
Character	Discernment, compassion, honesty and cooperative problem solving.
Child	- Demonstrate one choice tool and one mode-aware environmental change. - Participate in case solving without naming another child as 'bad' or 'tamasic.'

Primary Śrīla Prabhupāda Sources

- Review: Bhagavad-gītā 3.9
- Review: Bhagavad-gītā 18.63
- Review: Bhagavad-gītā 2.22
- Review: Bhagavad-gītā 14.5
- Review: Bhagavad-gītā 7.14

Key verse

Bhagavad-gītā 18.63

vimṛśyaitad ... yatheccchasi tathā kuru

Teaching memory line: Knowledge should lead to thoughtful, responsible choice under Kṛṣṇa's guidance.

Prem-kī-Kathā Script

Delivery target: 8–10 minutes of scripted narration plus 5–7 minutes of interaction. Do not exceed the 20-minute block.

A family has a recurring Friday problem. Everyone arrives late. The parent blames traffic, the children blame hunger, and another adult says, 'This is our karma; nothing can change.' The home is rushed, devices remain active and no one prepared food on time. By the time kīrtana begins, irritation has already spread.

A weak analysis picks one villain. A stronger analysis uses the whole cycle. Actions have reactions. The family has meaningful next choices, although it cannot control traffic. Repeated habits shape consciousness. Passion and ignorance are strengthened by last-minute rushing and disorder. Māyā makes the immediate convenience—one more screen, one more task, one delayed departure—appear more important than the protected purpose.

The solution is not to label the family or give a lecture about past lives. It is to identify the next controllable seed. Pack Thursday night. Move the meal earlier. Place devices in the car basket. Leave a fifteen-minute buffer. Chant once before driving. If late, enter quietly without spreading the disturbance. These actions do not guarantee a perfect evening. They change the direction.

Integration means seeing relationships between teachings. Karma without free will becomes fatalism. Free will without conditioning becomes arrogance. Modes without soul knowledge become labels. Māyā without surrender becomes despair. Reincarnation without daily remembrance becomes abstract information. Together, the teachings create responsible dependence on Kṛṣṇa.

Tonight each family will solve cases and then choose one method to continue. The goal is not to produce the cleverest answer. The goal is a plan that a tired family can actually execute. Kṛṣṇa consciousness advances through truthful choices made under real conditions.

Parent Lesson — 40 Minutes

215. 0–5 min — Explain the five-lens case method: action, choice, conditioning/modes, false promise and devotional shelter.
216. 5–25 min — Family case rounds. Each table receives two cases and prepares a three-minute response.
217. 25–32 min — Cross-table review: another family identifies one strength and one missing lens.
218. 32–36 min — Verse recognition relay without speed ranking.
219. 36–40 min — Select one continuing method and one measurable environmental change.

Children's Parallel Lesson — 40 Minutes

Common child timing: 0–5 opening/recall; 5–15 story or text; 15–28 movement, art, game or investigation; 28–35 verse/recall; 35–40 cleanup and family transition.

Age 4-6

- Puppet case: rushed morning. Children choose one helpful seed, use traffic-light pause and tidy the space.
- Mode-weather matching with actions that clear the sky.
- Bedtime remembrance demonstration.
- Choose one tool card to take home.

Age 7-9

- Solve illustrated cases using action, result, choice and helpful environment.
- Verse picture match: seed, rudder, clothes, filters and shelter.
- Role-play a respectful redo after a poor choice.
- Create a family tool wheel.

Age 10-13

- Facilitate a case using the five-lens method.
- Identify victim-blaming, fatalism and mode-labeling in sample statements.
- Design a realistic intervention for a digital attention loop.
- Give one evidence-based reason for the selected family method.

Analogy and Practical Example

Analogy

- Cycle 2 is a navigation system: karma shows consequences, free will turns the rudder, modes describe conditions, reincarnation extends the journey and surrender provides the

Practical family example

- A family identifies that late-night screens create morning dullness and missed chanting. Rather than calling anyone tamasic, they charge devices outside bedrooms, move one

route beyond māyā.	reading to after dinner and keep a one-minute bedtime remembrance.
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Questions: Discovery, Understanding and Application

Discovery

- Which verse and analogy belong to each Cycle 2 lesson?
- What factors are present in the case?
- What action can be changed now?

Understanding

- Why is one-lens analysis usually weak?
- How do modes and free will interact?
- Why must surrender include practical boundaries and responsible action?

Application

- Which Cycle 2 method produced the clearest benefit?
- What condition must change for it to continue?
- Who will support the plan without policing?

Bhakti Laboratory — Five-Lens Family Case Lab

220. Lens 1: What action and likely reaction are present?
221. Lens 2: What is controlled, influenced or not controlled?
222. Lens 3: Which mode-like conditions are active?
223. Lens 4: What false promise or attention loop is operating?
224. Lens 5: What responsible action and devotional shelter should be used next?
225. Families present in three minutes; facilitator corrects philosophy after the presentation, not during it.

Competency check

Family can produce a balanced case response using all five lenses and no harmful assumptions.

Family Home Practice

Field	Detail
Minimum	Continue one selected Cycle 2 method during the off week.
Standard	Use the method three times and make one environmental change.
Stretch	Teach the method to another family member using the cycle analogy map.
Evidence	Private continuity card with method, trigger and support.

Slide Outline

226. Cycle 2 integration
227. The five-lens method
228. Case round instructions
229. Common error: fatalism
230. Common error: victim-blaming
231. Common error: mode-labeling
232. Verse and analogy map
233. Choose one continuing method
234. Preview: Kṛṣṇa, guru and bhakti

Teacher Preparation

- Prepare at least six realistic cases with no recent family-specific details.
- Create facilitator answer guides with acceptable ranges, not one scripted solution.

- Review prohibited responses: karma diagnosis, victim blame, misogyny, child shaming and deterministic labels.
- Arrange mixed-age stations and ensure youth are not left as sole supervisors.
- Prepare continuity cards and private follow-up list.

Required Materials

Materials A • Five-lens mats • Case packets • Verse and analogy cards • Mode-weather cards • Puppets	Materials B • Tool wheels • Timers • Continuity cards • Pens and markers
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Assessment

- Score privately on five lenses, compassion and practicality.
- Secure = uses at least four lenses without a major misconception; developing = two or three; support = major misconception or no actionable plan.
- Children demonstrate tools through role-play, matching or explanation.
- No winning table or public score.

Newcomer Adaptation

KUTUMBA Setu application

Observers may join one case table with a mentor and receive the Cycle 2 analogy map. They are not assessed and should complete Setu foundations before formal entry into Cycle 3.

Risks and Sensitive Points

- Case nights can become indirect gossip; use fictional cases only.
- Do not reward confident speaking over correct and compassionate reasoning.
- Do not allow one adult to dominate the family answer.
- Integration must end with one practical method, not five new commitments.

Printable Worksheet — C2-W6

Integration Night: Choice, Consequence and the Modes

Key verse and memory line

Bhagavad-gītā 18.63

Knowledge should lead to thoughtful, responsible choice under Kṛṣṇa's guidance.

Case facts only: _____.

Action/reaction: _____.

Control/influence/no control: _____.

Mode-like conditions: _____.

False promise or māyā loop: _____.

Next responsible action: _____. Devotional shelter: _____.

Method we will continue: _____.

This Week's Saṅkalpa

Specific action: _____

Day/time and trigger: _____

Minimum version: _____

How we will review it: _____

Cycle 3 — Kṛṣṇa, Guru and the Process of Bhakti

Cycle driving question

Who is the Supreme Person, how do we receive genuine knowledge, and how does loving service become the center of family life?

Cycle outcomes

- Families understand Kṛṣṇa as the supreme enjoyer, proprietor, friend and source.
- Families can support Kṛṣṇa's supreme position from primary sources without sectarian aggression.
- Families use guru, sādhu and śāstra with inquiry, verification and safety boundaries.
- Families participate in attentive, non-competitive kīrtana.
- Families recognize the nine processes and establish a realistic thirty-day bhakti baseline.

Memorization and recognition

Primary cycle verse: Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 7.5.23–24 in stages. Recognition verses: BG 5.29, BG 7.7, BG 4.34 and Śikṣāṣṭakam 1.

Protected off week

Week 7 is a complete off week. Families begin the thirty-day baseline without group programming or additional assignments.

C3-W1 — Who Is God? The Supreme Enjoyer, Proprietor and Friend

Cycle 3 — Kṛṣṇa, Guru and the Process of Bhakti

Field	Detail
Week code	C3-W1
Cycle function	Foundational principle
Purpose	Give families a clear personal conception of God as the supreme conscious controller, proprietor, enjoyer, witness and well-wishing friend, and show how this knowledge brings practical peace.
Key verse	Bhagavad-gītā 5.29 — bhoktāraṁ yajña-tapasāṁ ... suhṛdaṁ sarva-bhūtānāṁ
Memory line	Peace comes from knowing Kṛṣṇa as the supreme enjoyer, proprietor of everything and friend of all living beings.
Bhakti laboratory	Stewardship Seva and Simple Offering Mood
Minimum home practice	Before one daily duty, remember: Kṛṣṇa owns, Kṛṣṇa enjoys, Kṛṣṇa is friend.

Learning Outcomes

Outcome domain	By the end of the session, participants should be able to...
Knowledge	- State the three peace-giving features in BG 5.29: supreme enjoyer, proprietor and friend of all beings. - Distinguish the Supreme Person from the individual soul and material nature. - Explain that God's proprietorship does not excuse irresponsibility; it creates stewardship.
Skill	- Reframe one conflict over control, credit or possession using the peace formula. - Explain God personally without relying only on vague energy language.
Practice	Use one daily 'Kṛṣṇa owns, Kṛṣṇa enjoys, Kṛṣṇa is friend' remembrance before a family duty.
Character	Stewardship, gratitude, reduced possessiveness and trust.
Child	- Say that Kṛṣṇa owns everything, accepts loving offerings and is the friend of every living being. - Show stewardship by caring for one shared item or living being.

Primary Śrīla Prabhupāda Sources

- Bhagavad-gītā 5.29
- Bhagavad-gītā 9.10
- Bhagavad-gītā 13.23
- Śrī Īśopaniṣad Invocation and Mantra 1
- Bhagavad-gītā 9.26

Key verse

Bhagavad-gītā 5.29

bhoktāraṁ yajña-tapasāṁ ... suhṛdaṁ sarva-bhūtānāṁ

Teaching memory line: Peace comes from knowing Kṛṣṇa as the supreme enjoyer, proprietor of everything and friend of all

living beings.

Prem-kī-Kathā Script

Delivery target: 8–10 minutes of scripted narration plus 5–7 minutes of interaction. Do not exceed the 20-minute block.

Two children argue over a room full of toys: ‘Mine!’ ‘No, mine!’ A parent intervenes, but later the adults have the same argument in a more sophisticated form—over money, credit, schedule, recognition or authority. Much family conflict begins with a hidden claim: ‘I am the owner, I am the enjoyer, and my plan should control everyone.’

Bhagavad-gītā 5.29 gives what Śrīla Prabhupāda often presents as the peace formula. Kṛṣṇa is the ultimate enjoyer of sacrifice and austerity, the proprietor of all worlds and the well-wishing friend of all living beings. These three truths rearrange the center of life.

If Kṛṣṇa is the proprietor, our home, ability, money, time and relationships are entrusted resources. Stewardship means care, planning and accountability—not neglect. If Kṛṣṇa is the enjoyer, service is arranged for His satisfaction rather than our applause. If Kṛṣṇa is the friend of all, His instruction is not exploitation; it is guidance from the one who knows and cares for every soul.

God is not merely an impersonal force in this curriculum. Material nature works under His direction. The Supersoul accompanies the individual living being as witness and guide. The individual soul is conscious but limited; God is the supreme conscious person. This distinction protects devotion from becoming self-worship.

Imagine managing a community garden owned by a generous benefactor for the benefit of everyone. A caretaker cannot say, ‘Nothing belongs to me, so I will let it decay.’ Nor can the caretaker fence it off and claim private ownership. The proper mood is grateful responsibility according to the owner’s purpose.

This week, use the peace formula during one conflict. Ask: What am I claiming to own? Whose satisfaction am I seeking? What would the well-wishing friend want for every person involved? Then make the next responsible decision. Peace is not passivity. It is action after the false center has been corrected.

Parent Lesson — 40 Minutes

- 235. 0–5 min — Possessive-language audit: list common ‘my’ claims in a family without public disclosure.
- 236. 5–13 min — Read BG 5.29 and identify enjoyer, proprietor, friend and the result—peace.
- 237. 13–20 min — Compare individual soul, material nature, Supersoul and Supreme Person using a simple four-part diagram.
- 238. 20–29 min — Case studies: money decision, child achievement, service credit and household authority. Apply the three peace questions.
- 239. 29–35 min — Stewardship versus neglect: discuss time, body, property and relationships as entrusted resources.
- 240. 35–40 min — Choose one daily duty and prepare a three-line remembrance before it.

Children’s Parallel Lesson — 40 Minutes

Common child timing: 0–5 opening/recall; 5–15 story or text; 15–28 movement, art, game or investigation; 28–35 verse/recall; 35–40 cleanup and family transition.

Age 4-6

- Shared basket activity: materials belong to Kṛṣṇa and are cared for by everyone.
- Three-picture chant: Kṛṣṇa receives, Kṛṣṇa owns, Kṛṣṇa is friend.
- Practice offering a flower or drawing with love, without teaching unapproved ritual details.
- Stewardship job: return one item clean and complete.

Age 7-9

- Peace-formula triangle labeled Enjoyer, Proprietor and Friend.
- Scenario sort: grabbing, wasting, sharing, caring and offering.
- Discuss why ‘Kṛṣṇa owns it’ means greater care, not careless use.
- Write one gratitude note for an entrusted resource.

Age 10-13

- Read BG 5.29 and explain why each feature matters for peace.
- Analyze creator, owner and user claims in digital content or group projects.
- Discuss the difference between God as person and God as only energy.
- Apply stewardship to money, talent, time or environmental care.

Analogy and Practical Example

Analogy We are caretakers in Kṛṣṇa's garden: real responsibility without false proprietorship.	Practical family example A parent treats a child's musical talent as family status. Using BG 5.29, the family reframes the talent as Kṛṣṇa's gift, protects healthy practice, removes comparison and finds an appropriate service use.
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Questions: Discovery, Understanding and Application

Discovery

- What three identities of Kṛṣṇa appear in BG 5.29?
- What result comes from knowing them?
- What does BG 9.10 indicate about material nature?

Understanding

- Why does Kṛṣṇa's ownership create stewardship rather than neglect?
- How does seeking Kṛṣṇa's satisfaction reduce competition?
- Why is a well-wishing friend qualified to guide?

Application

- What are you treating as exclusively 'mine'?
- Whose approval are you seeking in a current duty?
- What decision better serves all souls involved?

Bhakti Laboratory — Stewardship Seva and Simple Offering Mood

241. Choose a shared resource: books, instruments, altar cloths or classroom supplies.
242. Inspect, clean, count and return the items according to an approved checklist.
243. Before beginning, state: 'These resources belong to Kṛṣṇa; we care for them for service.'
244. Demonstrate the mood of offering a flower, water or drawing with love, while noting that exact worship procedures require approved guidance.
245. Close with gratitude for the resource and the people who maintain it.

Competency check

Participant demonstrates stewardship and can explain all three parts of the peace formula.

Family Home Practice

Field	Detail
Minimum	Before one daily duty, remember: Kṛṣṇa owns, Kṛṣṇa enjoys, Kṛṣṇa is friend.
Standard	Use the three peace questions during one disagreement and record the changed action.
Stretch	Select one family resource and create a simple maintenance responsibility.
Evidence	Private note; no disclosure of financial amounts or conflicts.

Slide Outline

246. The hidden 'mine' argument
247. BG 5.29: the peace formula
248. Supreme enjoyer
249. Proprietor of everything
250. Friend of all living beings
251. Jīva, nature, Supersoul and Bhagavān
252. Stewardship, not neglect

253. Three peace questions
 254. Home remembrance

Teacher Preparation

- Read BG 5.29, 9.10, 13.23, 9.26 and Īsopaniṣad Mantra 1 with purports.
- Prepare the four-part diagram and avoid overcomplicated tattva terminology.
- Select shared materials for a real stewardship task.
- Brief teachers not to use God's ownership to pressure donations or control personal property.
- Prepare interfaith-sensitive wording: teach KUTUMBA's siddhānta without mocking other conceptions.

Required Materials

Materials A • Peace-formula triangle cards • Four-part tattva diagram • Shared supply inventory • Cleaning cloths	Materials B • Flower/water/drawing demonstration items • Scenario cards • Worksheets • Timer
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Assessment

- Adult explains the three features and applies them to one case.
- Adult distinguishes stewardship from neglect and coercion.
- Child names all three features with picture support.
- Observe whether participants can care for a shared item without possessiveness or carelessness.

Newcomer Adaptation

KUTUMBA Setu application

Give the body–soul and Kṛṣṇa-as-source bridge card. New families can participate fully because this lesson reestablishes the program's personal conception of God.

Risks and Sensitive Points

- Do not use Kṛṣṇa's ownership to demand money, property, obedience or unpaid labor.
- Do not turn the session into a debate against other religions.
- Do not confuse the individual soul or Supersoul with Kṛṣṇa in all respects.
- Avoid implying that trust in Kṛṣṇa removes the need for planning and safeguards.

Printable Worksheet — C3-W1

Who Is God? The Supreme Enjoyer, Proprietor and Friend

Key verse and memory line

Bhagavad-gītā 5.29

Peace comes from knowing Kṛṣṇa as the supreme enjoyer, proprietor of everything and friend of all living beings.

Kṛṣṇa is the supreme _____, _____ and _____.

A resource entrusted to me: _____.

How I will care for it: _____.

In one conflict, I am claiming ownership of _____.

Kṛṣṇa-centered next action: _____.

Child box: Draw something you will care for because it belongs to Kṛṣṇa.

This Week's Saṅkalpa

Specific action: _____

Day/time and trigger: _____

Minimum version: _____

How we will review it: _____

C3-W2 — Who Is Kṛṣṇa? The Supreme Personality of Godhead

Cycle 3 — Kṛṣṇa, Guru and the Process of Bhakti

Field	Detail
Week code	C3-W2
Cycle function	Scriptural story and application
Purpose	Establish Kṛṣṇa's unique supreme position from Śrīla Prabhupāda's primary sources while introducing His attractive personal qualities and pastimes without premature or speculative treatment of confidential subjects.
Key verse	Bhagavad-gītā 7.7 — mattaḥ parataram nānyat kiñcid asti dhanañjaya
Memory line	There is no truth superior to Kṛṣṇa; everything rests upon Him like pearls on a thread.
Bhakti laboratory	Authorized Kṛṣṇa-Kathā Retelling
Minimum home practice	Remember one name or quality of Kṛṣṇa once daily.

Learning Outcomes

Outcome domain	By the end of the session, participants should be able to...
Knowledge	- State that Kṛṣṇa is the source of all spiritual and material existence and that nothing is superior to Him. - Recognize Kṛṣṇa as simultaneously personal, supreme, all-attractive and approachable through devotion. - Identify the difference between honoring many empowered beings and recognizing the ultimate source.
Skill	- Support Kṛṣṇa's supreme position with BG 7.7, BG 10.8 and ŚB 1.3.28. - Tell one age-appropriate Kṛṣṇa pastime with a clear philosophical point and no invented details.
Practice	Choose one name, quality or authorized pastime of Kṛṣṇa to remember daily.
Character	Wonder, affection, theological clarity and avoidance of sectarian aggression.
Child	- Say that Kṛṣṇa is the Supreme Personality of Godhead and the source of everything. - Name one quality of Kṛṣṇa shown in an authorized pastime.

Primary Śrīla Prabhupāda Sources

- Bhagavad-gītā 7.7
- Bhagavad-gītā 10.8
- Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.3.28
- Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Introduction
- Kṛṣṇa Book chapters on Govardhana-līlā and Brahmā's prayers, selected according to age

Key verse

Bhagavad-gītā 7.7

mattaḥ parataram nānyat kiñcid asti dhanañjaya

Teaching memory line: There is no truth superior to Kṛṣṇa; everything rests upon Him like pearls on a thread.

Prem-kī-Kathā Script

Delivery target: 8–10 minutes of scripted narration plus 5–7 minutes of interaction. Do not exceed the 20-minute block.

A child asks, ‘There are so many powerful beings and so many names. Why does KUTUMBA say Kṛṣṇa is Supreme?’ The correct answer is not ‘because our group says so.’ Devotional conviction should be grounded in śāstra as presented by the ācārya.

In Bhagavad-gītā 7.7, Kṛṣṇa states that no truth is superior to Him and that everything rests on Him like pearls on a thread. In Bhagavad-gītā 10.8, He says He is the source of the spiritual and material worlds. Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.3.28 identifies Kṛṣṇa as the original Personality of Godhead while other avatāras are portions or portions of portions.

Supremacy in Kṛṣṇa is not a cold idea of size or force. Kṛṣṇa is all-attractive. He protects Vraja by lifting Govardhana Hill. He accepts the affection of His devotees. He defeats pride, yet invites loving relationship. His powers do not erase His personhood. His childhood form is not helpless material limitation; His acts reveal inconceivable supremacy and sweetness.

The pearls-on-a-thread analogy is useful. We see individual pearls but may not see the thread holding the necklace together. In the same way, causes, powers and personalities exist, yet their existence and capacity rest upon Kṛṣṇa. The analogy does not mean Kṛṣṇa is only an invisible impersonal support. He is the speaker, source and Supreme Person.

We teach this without disrespect. A confident devotee does not need to mock another faith or turn every conversation into a contest. We can say: ‘According to Bhagavad-gītā As It Is and Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam as taught by Śrīla Prabhupāda, Kṛṣṇa is the Supreme Personality of Godhead.’ Then we live in a way that reflects gratitude and service.

This week choose one authorized name, quality or pastime: Govinda who gives pleasure to the senses and cows, Gopāla who protects, Giridhārī who lifted Govardhana, or Kṛṣṇa as the source of all. Remember it before chanting or at one daily transition. Let theological clarity grow into relationship.

Parent Lesson — 40 Minutes

- 255. 0–5 min — Opening question: ‘What evidence would distinguish conviction from preference?’
- 256. 5–15 min — Text triangle: BG 7.7, BG 10.8 and ŚB 1.3.28. Groups summarize what each adds.
- 257. 15–22 min — Read a brief summary from the Kṛṣṇa Book Introduction on Kṛṣṇa’s supreme identity.
- 258. 22–30 min — Govardhana case: identify Kṛṣṇa’s supremacy, protection, reciprocation and correction of pride.
- 259. 30–35 min — Respectful explanation practice: answer a sincere question without attack or vague universalism.
- 260. 35–40 min — Select one authorized name/quality/pastime for daily remembrance.

Children’s Parallel Lesson — 40 Minutes

Common child timing: 0–5 opening/recall; 5–15 story or text; 15–28 movement, art, game or investigation; 28–35 verse/recall; 35–40 cleanup and family transition.

Age 4-6

- Tell Govardhana-līlā using authorized, simple details and a felt-board or figures.
- Quality cards: strong, protective, playful, loving and all-attractive.
- Pearl necklace demonstration with visible thread.
- Recall: ‘Kṛṣṇa is the Supreme Lord and protects His devotees.’

Age 7-9

- Sequence Govardhana events and identify what each event shows about Kṛṣṇa.
- Read the English memory line of BG 7.7 and build a pearl-thread craft.
- Sort claims into verse-supported, story-supported and invented.
- Choose one Kṛṣṇa name and write its remembered quality.

Age 10-13

- Compare the claims of BG 7.7, BG 10.8 and ŚB 1.3.28.
- Discuss why extraordinary childhood pastimes do not make Kṛṣṇa an ordinary mythic hero.
- Analyze respectful conviction versus aggressive debate and vague relativism.
- Prepare a two-minute authorized pastime retelling with source, principle and application.

Analogy and Practical Example

Analogy	Practical family example
• Everything rests on Kṛṣṇa like pearls on a thread; the thread supports the necklace, yet Kṛṣṇa is more than an impersonal	• A child asks whether Kṛṣṇa is simply one cultural god. The parent opens BG 7.7, explains the verse in plain language

support—He is the Supreme Person and source.

and shares Govardhana-līlā as evidence of Kṛṣṇa's protective supremacy, without insulting anyone else.

Questions: Discovery, Understanding and Application

Discovery

- What claim does Kṛṣṇa make in BG 7.7?
- What source relationship is stated in BG 10.8?
- How does ŚB 1.3.28 describe Kṛṣṇa among avatāras?

Understanding

- Why is Kṛṣṇa's supremacy personal and attractive rather than merely forceful?
- What does the thread analogy explain and not explain?
- How can conviction remain respectful?

Application

- Which name or quality of Kṛṣṇa will you remember?
- Which authorized pastime can your family retell accurately?
- How will this understanding affect your chanting or offering?

Bhakti Laboratory — Authorized Kṛṣṇa-Kathā Retelling

261. Use a four-card structure: source, event, quality of Kṛṣṇa, family application.
262. Facilitator models a three-minute Govardhana retelling without invented dialogue.
263. Families prepare a ninety-second retelling from supplied source summaries.
264. Listeners identify the quality and application, not performance style.
265. Teacher corrects factual errors kindly after the retelling.

Competency check

Family can retell one Kṛṣṇa pastime accurately with a clear philosophical principle and practical application.

Family Home Practice

Field	Detail
Minimum	Remember one name or quality of Kṛṣṇa once daily.
Standard	Retell the selected pastime once at home using the four-card method.
Stretch	Read the relevant Kṛṣṇa Book chapter as adults and prepare one child-safe paragraph.
Evidence	Family records the source reference and one remembered quality.

Slide Outline

266. Why do we say Kṛṣṇa is Supreme?
267. BG 7.7: no truth superior
268. BG 10.8: source of all
269. ŚB 1.3.28: Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself
270. Kṛṣṇa is all-attractive
271. Govardhana: protection and reciprocation
272. Pearls on a thread
273. Respectful conviction
274. Daily remembrance

Teacher Preparation

- Read the assigned verses, Kṛṣṇa Book Introduction and selected Govardhana passages.
- Use only authorized summaries; do not invent dialogue, motivations or rasa details.

- Keep confidential Vraja topics outside this foundational module.
- Prepare visual aids that are respectful and not entertainment-heavy.
- Brief teachers to avoid interfaith debate and disparagement of devas or other traditions.

Required Materials

Materials A • Govardhana felt board or figures • Pearl necklace and thread • Text triangle cards • Quality cards	Materials B • Four-card retelling templates • Source summaries • Worksheets • Timer
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Assessment

- Adult supports Kṛṣṇa's supreme position with at least two assigned references.
- Family retells one pastime without invented facts and states one quality.
- Child identifies Kṛṣṇa as Supreme and names one quality.
- Teacher checks for disrespectful comparison or premature confidential content.

Newcomer Adaptation

KUTUMBA Setu application

Provide the peace-formula card from the previous week and the three-verse evidence triangle. Newcomers can join the pastime retelling with a supplied source summary.

Risks and Sensitive Points

- Do not reduce Kṛṣṇa to a cultural symbol or mythic superhero.
- Do not invent pastimes or teach confidential topics prematurely.
- Do not disrespect devas, other faiths or sincere questioners.
- Do not let visual storytelling replace source verification.

Printable Worksheet — C3-W2

Who Is Kṛṣṇa? The Supreme Personality of Godhead

Key verse and memory line

Bhagavad-gītā 7.7

There is no truth superior to Kṛṣṇa; everything rests upon Him like pearls on a thread.

BG 7.7 teaches _____.

BG 10.8 teaches _____.

ŚB 1.3.28 teaches _____.

Pastime source: _____. What happened: _____.

Quality of Kṛṣṇa shown: _____.

How our family can respond: _____.

This Week's Saṅkalpa

Specific action: _____

Day/time and trigger: _____

Minimum version: _____

How we will review it: _____

C3-W3 — Guru, Sādhū and Śāstra: How We Receive Spiritual Knowledge

Cycle 3 — Kṛṣṇa, Guru and the Process of Bhakti

Field	Detail
Week code	C3-W3
Cycle function	Practical bhakti laboratory
Purpose	Teach a safe and authoritative knowledge pathway through bona fide guru, saintly devotees and scripture, while clarifying roles, inquiry, service, verification and the limits of KUTUMBA authority.
Key verse	Bhagavad-gītā 4.34 — tad viddhi praṇipātena paripraśnena sevayā
Memory line	Approach spiritual truth with humility, sincere inquiry and service; realized teachers can impart knowledge.
Bhakti laboratory	Source Verification and Question Practice
Minimum home practice	Write one sincere spiritual question and locate one relevant Śrīla Prabhupāda source.

Learning Outcomes

Outcome domain	By the end of the session, participants should be able to...
Knowledge	- Explain the three elements guru, sādhu and śāstra and why they should harmonize. - State the core approach of BG 4.34: humility, relevant inquiry and service. - Distinguish a teacher, mentor, temple authority, śikṣā-guru and dīkṣā-guru at a basic level without making appointments or promises.
Skill	- Formulate a sincere, specific and text-grounded question. - Check a teaching against assigned primary sources and authorized guidance.
Practice	Bring one real spiritual question to scripture and a qualified devotee this week.
Character	Humility, discernment, service mood and freedom from personality cults.
Child	- Know that trustworthy spiritual learning comes through scripture and qualified devotees. - Understand that adults must follow safety boundaries and no teacher is above correction or safeguarding.

Primary Śrīla Prabhupāda Sources

- Bhagavad-gītā 4.34
- Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.3.21
- Caitanya-caritāmṛta Madhya 20.122
- Bhagavad-gītā 2.7
- KUTUMBA source-authority and temple-relationship policies

Key verse

Bhagavad-gītā 4.34

tad viddhi praṇipātena paripraśnena sevayā

Teaching memory line: Approach spiritual truth with humility, sincere inquiry and service; realized teachers can impart

knowledge.

Prem-kī-Kathā Script

Delivery target: 8–10 minutes of scripted narration plus 5–7 minutes of interaction. Do not exceed the 20-minute block.

A family hears three different answers online to the same spiritual question. One speaker is charismatic, another has many followers and a third quotes a verse without context. The family asks, ‘How do we know what to accept?’ Devotional life requires faith, but not gullibility.

Bhagavad-gītā 4.34 gives a disciplined approach: humility, sincere inquiry and service. Arjuna himself first admits confusion and accepts Kṛṣṇa’s guidance. Inquiry is not rebellion when it is relevant and honest. Service is not payment for secret knowledge. It develops receptivity and relationship with qualified guidance.

Guru, sādhu and śāstra should not be treated as three unrelated opinion sources. Śāstra provides revealed authority. Sādhus live and explain the teachings. A bona fide guru represents the disciplic succession and guides the disciple without contradicting scripture and the previous ācāryas. Harmony protects us from self-invention and from following personality alone.

KUTUMBA has limited authority. A facilitator may teach an approved lesson, mentor a family in basic habits and refer questions. KUTUMBA does not appoint someone’s initiating guru, promise initiation, replace temple leadership or manufacture worship standards. A confident boundary increases trust.

Think of navigation by map, experienced guide and reliable landmarks. A guide who tells you to throw away the map is unsafe. A traveler who owns the map but refuses all guidance may misread it. Landmarks help confirm that the route matches reality. Similarly, guru, sādhu and śāstra work in harmony.

Safety also matters. Spiritual status never cancels child protection, consent, financial accountability or lawful conduct. Questions about misconduct should not be silenced as offenses. Proper respect and proper safeguards are compatible.

This week, take one real question. Write what you already know, locate one primary source and ask a qualified devotee with humility. Record the source and answer rather than remembering only the personality who spoke.

Parent Lesson — 40 Minutes

- 275. 0–5 min — Source check: participants rank a viral quote, anonymous post, Śrīla Prabhupāda book, trained teacher and personal intuition by authority for doctrine.
- 276. 5–13 min — Read BG 4.34 and identify humility, inquiry, service and qualified knowledge.
- 277. 13–21 min — Guru–sādhu–śāstra triangle. Explain harmony and basic role distinctions.
- 278. 21–29 min — Case studies: charismatic contradiction, teacher speculation, pressure for initiation and a genuine safeguarding concern.
- 279. 29–35 min — Question clinic: convert vague, combative or dependent questions into specific, text-grounded inquiry.
- 280. 35–40 min — Choose one question, one source and one qualified person to approach.

Children’s Parallel Lesson — 40 Minutes

Common child timing: 0–5 opening/recall; 5–15 story or text; 15–28 movement, art, game or investigation; 28–35 verse/recall; 35–40 cleanup and family transition.

Age 4-6

- Three helpers picture: sacred book, trustworthy devotee and teacher who follows the book.
- Follow-the-map game with visible route and adult guide.
- Practice asking: ‘Can you show me where this comes from?’
- Safety truth: tell parents or designated adults if any adult asks for secrecy or makes you unsafe.

Age 7-9

- Guru–sādhu–śāstra triangle puzzle.
- Source sorting: book quote, teacher explanation, made-up claim and internet rumor.
- Write one respectful spiritual question.
- Learn that respect never means hiding unsafe behavior.

Age 10-13

- Read BG 4.34 and discuss difference between inquiry and argument for ego.
- Analyze authority claims: title, popularity, behavior, source consistency and accountability.

- Practice verifying a quote in an assigned primary source.
- Review digital and child-safety boundaries with spiritual teachers and mentors.

Analogy and Practical Example

Analogy • Guru, sādhu and śāstra are like an experienced guide, reliable map and confirming landmarks; trustworthy direction requires harmony.	Practical family example • A facilitator gives a confident answer about an initiation rule but cannot cite a source. The correct response is not to defend the facilitator. The question is recorded and referred to the temple or authorized authority before teaching it as policy.
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Questions: Discovery, Understanding and Application

Discovery

- What three approaches are named in BG 4.34?
- What should characterize a spiritual master in ŚB 11.3.21?
- What does CC Madhya 20.122 say about the living entity's constitutional position?

Understanding

- Why should guru, sādhu and śāstra harmonize?
- Why is humility compatible with verification?
- What authority does KUTUMBA not possess?

Application

- What question needs an authoritative answer?
- Which primary source can you consult first?
- Who is qualified to answer or refer it?

Bhakti Laboratory — Source Verification and Question Practice

281. Provide a short claim and three possible sources.
282. Participants locate the verse or approved excerpt in a printed/digital index.
283. Write the claim, source, context and practical conclusion.
284. Role-play asking a qualified teacher using humility, specific inquiry and willingness to serve.
285. If the answer is uncertain, practice saying: 'I do not know; I will verify and return.'

Competency check

Participant can verify a basic claim and ask a specific spiritual question without speculation or personality dependence.

Family Home Practice

Field	Detail
Minimum	Write one sincere spiritual question and locate one relevant Śrīla Prabhupāda source.
Standard	Ask a qualified devotee and record the source-based answer.
Stretch	Teach the family the guru–sādhu–śāstra triangle and one safety boundary.
Evidence	Question log with no confidential names or allegations in the shared curriculum system.

Slide Outline

286. Three answers online
287. BG 4.34: humility, inquiry and service
288. Guru–sādhu–śāstra triangle
289. Basic authority roles

- 290. What KUTUMBA can and cannot do
- 291. Map, guide and landmarks
- 292. Respect and safeguarding
- 293. How to verify a claim
- 294. Ask one real question

Teacher Preparation

- Read BG 4.34, SB 11.3.21, CC Madhya 20.122 and KUTUMBA authority policies.
- Confirm exact language with the temple liaison for initiation, guru and worship boundaries.
- Prepare source-verification exercises using only authorized texts.
- Review child-protection escalation and explain that misconduct reports are not gossip or offense when handled properly.
- Instruct teachers to say 'I do not know' rather than improvise.

Required Materials

Materials A	Materials B
• Guru—sādhū—śāstra triangle puzzles • Source authority cards • Printed verse index or tablets with approved links • Claim verification sheets	• Question cards • Safety boundary handout • Timer

Assessment

- Adult identifies primary doctrinal authority and KUTUMBA's limits.
- Adult verifies one claim and formulates one specific question.
- Child can ask for a source and identify a trusted-adult safety response.
- Teacher records unresolved questions for formal review.

Newcomer Adaptation

KUTUMBA Setu application

Provide the source hierarchy card and explain that no prior guru relationship is assumed. New families are not asked about initiation plans or personal allegiance.

Risks and Sensitive Points

- Do not pressure participants to select a guru or seek initiation.
- Do not equate questioning misconduct with Vaiṣṇava-aparādha.
- Do not allow facilitators to present personal opinion as siddhānta.
- Do not invite confidential allegations into open group discussion; use proper reporting channels.

Printable Worksheet — C3-W3

Guru, Sādhū and Śāstra: How We Receive Spiritual Knowledge

Key verse and memory line

Bhagavad-gītā 4.34

Approach spiritual truth with humility, sincere inquiry and service; realized teachers can impart knowledge.

My question: _____.

What I think I know: _____.

Primary source checked: _____.

What the source actually says in context: _____.

Qualified person to ask: _____. Why qualified: _____.

If uncertain, the responsible response is _____.

This Week's Saṅkalpa

Specific action: _____

Day/time and trigger: _____

Minimum version: _____

How we will review it: _____

C3-W4 — Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu and the Holy Name

Cycle 3 — Kṛṣṇa, Guru and the Process of Bhakti

Field	Detail
Week code	C3-W4
Cycle function	Parent and child formation
Purpose	Introduce Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu's gift of congregational chanting and help families experience attentive, humble and joyful nāma practice without performance pressure or claims of advanced realization.
Key verse	Caitanya-caritāmṛta Antya 20.12 — Śikṣāṣṭakam 1 — ceto-darpaṇa-mārjanam ... paraṁ vijayate śrī-kṛṣṇa-saṅkīrtanam
Memory line	The congregational chanting of Kṛṣṇa's holy name cleanses the heart and expands spiritual life.
Bhakti laboratory	Attentive Family Kīrtana
Minimum home practice	Five-minute family kīrtana or attentive mantra listening on three days.

Learning Outcomes

Outcome domain	By the end of the session, participants should be able to...
Knowledge	- Identify Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu as Kṛṣṇa who taught and spread saṅkīrtana according to Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇava understanding. - Explain key effects named in Śikṣāṣṭakam 1: cleansing the heart and awakening spiritual good fortune. - State that the holy name is spiritually potent and should be approached with respect, patience and authorized guidance.
Skill	- Participate in call-and-response kīrtana with attention to hearing and appropriate volume. - Use one simple method to return attention when the mind wanders during chanting.
Practice	Complete one five-minute family kīrtana or japa-listening practice on three days.
Character	Humility, joy, perseverance and non-performance.
Child	- Recognize Lord Caitanya and the Pañca-tattva and participate respectfully in the mahā-mantra. - Know that loudness, speed and musical skill do not determine devotion.

Primary Śrīla Prabhupāda Sources

- Caitanya-caritāmṛta Antya 20.12 (Śikṣāṣṭakam 1)
- Caitanya-caritāmṛta Ādi 7.163
- Caitanya-caritāmṛta Ādi 17.21
- Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 12.3.51
- Śrīla Prabhupāda's standard teaching and practice of the Hare Kṛṣṇa mahā-mantra

Key verse

Caitanya-caritāmṛta Antya 20.12 — Śikṣāṣṭakam 1
ceto-darpaṇa-mārjanam ... paraṁ vijayate śrī-kṛṣṇa-saṅkīrtanam

Teaching memory line: The congregational chanting of Kṛṣṇa's holy name cleanses the heart and expands spiritual life.

Prem-kī-Kathā Script

Delivery target: 8–10 minutes of scripted narration plus 5–7 minutes of interaction. Do not exceed the 20-minute block.

A family begins kīrtana. One child sings loudly and proudly, another is shy, one adult worries about melody, and another silently checks whether people are impressed. The holy name is present, but the mind has turned chanting into performance.

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu spread the congregational chanting of Kṛṣṇa's names. In Śikṣāṣṭakam 1, He glorifies saṅkīrtana as cleansing the mirror of the heart, cooling the fire of material existence and expanding the ocean of spiritual happiness. A dirty mirror does not create a new face; cleaning reveals what was obscured. Similarly, chanting gradually clears coverings so the soul's relationship with Kṛṣṇa can awaken.

The Jharikhaṇḍa forest pastime gives a joyful picture: through Lord Caitanya's influence, even animals chanted and danced together. We should not imitate extraordinary symptoms. The foundational lesson is that the holy name is a gift for everyone and creates a shared center beyond ordinary divisions.

Attentive chanting begins with hearing. The mind will wander. The practice is not to become angry with the mind or pretend perfect concentration. Hear one mantra. When attention leaves, gently return to the sound. In kīrtana, follow the leader, respond together, protect the devotional mood and leave space for others.

Musical training matters for orderly service, but musical skill is not spiritual rank. Fast tempo, dramatic voice or long leadership does not prove purity. Children should not be compared. Adults should not compete. The holy name is Kṛṣṇa's mercy, not our stage.

This week create a five-minute family chanting appointment. Use a familiar melody, moderate pace and one clear instruction: listen to the full mantra. When someone becomes distracted, do not scold. Point back to the sound. Let the home experience the holy name as shelter rather than examination.

Parent Lesson — 40 Minutes

- 295. 0–5 min — Listening test: hear one softly spoken mantra and write which words attention actually caught.
- 296. 5–13 min — Read the memory line from Śikṣāṣṭakam 1. Explain mirror, fire and expanding ocean as teaching images.
- 297. 13–20 min — Short authorized account of Lord Caitanya's saṅkīrtana mission and Jharikhaṇḍa, avoiding sensationalism.
- 298. 20–28 min — Kīrtana etiquette: leader responsibility, response, volume, tempo, instruments and inclusion.
- 299. 28–34 min — Attention practice: hear one mantra, notice wandering, return without self-attack.
- 300. 34–40 min — Design the family five-minute practice and select melody, place, cue and child role.

Children's Parallel Lesson — 40 Minutes

Common child timing: 0–5 opening/recall; 5–15 story or text; 15–28 movement, art, game or investigation; 28–35 verse/recall; 35–40 cleanup and family transition.

Age 4-6

- Mirror cleaning demonstration with a safely smudged acrylic mirror.
- Pañca-tattva picture introduction and call-and-response names.
- Animal movement kīrtana inspired by Jharikhaṇḍa, kept orderly and brief.
- Listening game: raise a hand when the full mahā-mantra ends.

Age 7-9

- Sequence Lord Caitanya's gift: chant, hear, cleanse, remember, share.
- Kīrtana role cards: leader, responder, kartāl support, respectful listener and space helper.
- Attention bead: move one bead after hearing one complete mantra.
- Discuss why skill and devotion are not the same measurement.

Age 10-13

- Read the English meaning of Śikṣāṣṭakam 1 and interpret the three main images.
- Analyze performance motives in music and social media without judging individuals.
- Practice leading two moderate call-and-response mantras with a clear ending.
- Create an attention-recovery plan for japa or kīrtana.

Analogy and Practical Example

Analogy Chanting cleans the heart like cleaning a mirror: it removes covering so spiritual identity and relationship can be seen more clearly.	Practical family example A child sings off-key. The leader does not correct publicly or laugh. The leader keeps a steady melody, thanks the child for responding and provides optional music practice separately.
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Questions: Discovery, Understanding and Application

Discovery

- What effects of saṅkīrtana are named in Śikṣāṣṭakam 1?
- What did Lord Caitanya and His associates distribute?
- What is the first practical action when attention wanders?

Understanding

- Why is the mirror image useful?
- Why is musical skill not proof of spiritual advancement?
- What is the difference between joyful expression and imitation of advanced symptoms?

Application

- What cue will begin your five-minute family practice?
- How will every child have a safe role?
- What will you do when someone is distracted or reluctant?

Bhakti Laboratory — Attentive Family Kīrtana

- Review the Pañca-tattva mantra and mahā-mantra according to approved local practice.
- Leader uses one simple melody and moderate tempo for two short rounds.
- Responders listen before answering; kartāls, if used, follow the trained pattern and volume.
- Pause for ten seconds and ask: which word did you hear most clearly?
- Repeat with improved attention and a clean ending.

Competency check

Family can participate in a five-minute call-and-response kīrtana with attentive hearing, appropriate volume and no competition.

Family Home Practice

Field	Detail
Minimum	Five-minute family kīrtana or attentive mantra listening on three days.
Standard	Use one cue, one melody and one attention reminder consistently.
Stretch	One adult or older child practices a two-minute lead under a trained person's guidance.
Evidence	Private check marks and one note: what helped hearing?

Slide Outline

- When kīrtana becomes performance
- Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu's gift
- Śikṣāṣṭakam 1
- Cleaning the mirror of the heart
- Jharikhāṇḍa: the holy name for everyone
- Hear and return
- Kīrtana etiquette

313. Skill is service, not rank
 314. Five-minute home kīrtana

Teacher Preparation

- Read CC Antya 20.12, CC Ādi 7.163, CC Ādi 17.21 and the selected Jharikhaṇḍa account.
- Confirm local approved mantra order, melodies, instrument patterns and worship etiquette with the kīrtana/worship lead.
- Prepare a simple melody within the leader's competence.
- Brief teachers: no imitation of tears, shaking or advanced symptoms; no child performance ranking.
- Check instrument safety, volume and two-adult supervision during movement activities.

Required Materials

Materials A	Materials B
• Pañca-tattva image • Acrylic mirror and washable marker • Mantra cards • Kartāls for trained use	• Role cards • Attention beads • Timer • Optional approved audio reference

Assessment

- Adult states two effects of saṅkīrtana and one attention method.
- Family completes a five-minute kīrtana with appropriate response and ending.
- Child participates without being evaluated for voice quality.
- Teacher records practical coaching needs for leaders and instrumentalists.

Newcomer Adaptation

KUTUMBA Setu application

Teach the Pañca-tattva mantra and mahā-mantra pronunciation briefly before the session or during Setu. Newcomers may simply respond or listen; no one is asked to lead.

Risks and Sensitive Points

- Do not equate loud, fast or emotional chanting with purity.
- Do not force shy children or adults to sing solo.
- Do not improvise mantra order, āraṭi procedure or instrument standards.
- Do not mock imperfect pronunciation; correct gently and privately when needed.

Printable Worksheet — C3-W4

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu and the Holy Name

Key verse and memory line

Caitanya-caritāmṛta Antya 20.12 — Śikṣāṣṭakam 1

The congregational chanting of Kṛṣṇa's holy name cleanses the heart and expands spiritual life.

Śikṣāṣṭakam 1 compares chanting to cleaning _____.

One effect of chanting named in the verse: _____.

My attention usually wanders to _____.

My return method: hear one word / slow down / look at mantra card / other _____.

Family cue: _____. Child roles: _____.

Kīrtana is not a competition because _____.

This Week's Saṅkalpa

Specific action: _____

Day/time and trigger: _____

Minimum version: _____

How we will review it: _____

C3-W5 — The Nine Processes of Bhakti

Cycle 3 — Kṛṣṇa, Guru and the Process of Bhakti

Field	Detail
Week code	C3-W5
Cycle function	Case study, practice and service
Purpose	Give families a broad, scriptural map of devotional service so bhakti is experienced as a whole life of hearing, chanting, remembering, worship, prayer, service, friendship and surrender—not only classroom attendance.
Key verse	Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 7.5.23–24 — śravaṇaṁ kīrtanaṁ viṣṇoḥ smaraṇaṁ pāda-sevanam
Memory line	Hearing, chanting, remembering, serving, worshipping, praying, serving as a servant, friendship and full surrender are processes of pure devotional service.
Bhakti laboratory	Nine-Process Bhakti Stations
Minimum home practice	Continue the family's core practice and add one underused process once.

Learning Outcomes

Outcome domain	By the end of the session, participants should be able to...
Knowledge	- Name the nine processes from ŚB 7.5.23–24 at recognition level. - Explain that one process practiced purely can bring perfection and that processes often support one another. - Identify age-appropriate household examples of each process.
Skill	- Diagnose which devotional processes are present or absent in a family routine. - Design a balanced seven-day bhakti menu without overloading the family.
Practice	Strengthen one underused process while continuing the family's core hearing and chanting.
Character	Service variety, appreciation of different strengths, steadiness and surrender.
Child	- Recognize all nine processes through pictures and actions. - Choose one process they enjoy and one they want to learn.

Primary Śrīla Prabhupāda Sources

- Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 7.5.23–24
- Bhagavad-gītā 9.14
- Caitanya-caritāmṛta Madhya 22.128–129
- Selected examples from Śrīla Prabhupāda's purport to ŚB 7.5.23–24

Key verse

Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 7.5.23–24

śravaṇaṁ kīrtanaṁ viṣṇoḥ smaraṇaṁ pāda-sevanam

Teaching memory line: Hearing, chanting, remembering, serving, worshipping, praying, serving as a servant, friendship and full surrender are processes of pure devotional service.

Prem-kī-Kathā Script

Delivery target: 8–10 minutes of scripted narration plus 5–7 minutes of interaction. Do not exceed the 20-minute block.

A family says, 'We do bhakti every Friday.' But during the week, no one hears, chants, remembers, prays, serves or offers anything. Another family chants daily but never serves together and becomes critical of others. A third enjoys festivals but avoids scripture. Each has something valuable, yet bhakti has become narrow.

Prahlāda Mahārāja presents nine processes: hearing about Viṣṇu, chanting, remembering, serving the Lord's feet, worship, prayer, servitorship, friendship and full surrender. Śrīla Prabhupāda explains that one process performed without deviation can bring perfection, and that processes naturally combine. The list is not a checklist for competition. It is a map showing how the whole person can relate to Kṛṣṇa.

Hearing gives content. Chanting expresses and reinforces remembrance. Worship trains attention and care. Prayer brings the heart before Kṛṣṇa. Dāśya turns duty into service. Sakhya develops trust and personal relationship. Ātma-nivedana places one's plans and identity under Kṛṣṇa's shelter. Children can participate through simple, trained and safe forms of each.

Imagine a balanced meal. A person may have a favorite preparation, but living only on one sweet is not a wise family diet. The analogy is limited because pure devotion is not material nutrition and one process can be complete. Still, for beginners, a varied bhakti menu helps the family discover strengths and avoid reducing spiritual life to lecture attendance.

Different family members may connect through different services. One child remembers stories, another likes singing, one parent enjoys cooking, another quietly maintains books and schedules. Variety should lead to cooperation, not spiritual ranking. The center remains pleasing Kṛṣṇa under authorized guidance.

This week keep your core practice small and add only one underused process. If the home hears but rarely serves, choose one service. If the family performs activity but rarely prays, add one sincere prayer. If worship is present but reading is absent, read one passage. Do not add nine commitments. Use the map to take one balanced step.

Parent Lesson — 40 Minutes

315. 0–5 min — Brain dump: what activities does your family currently call bhakti?
316. 5–15 min — Read ŚB 7.5.23–24 in sections and build a nine-process wall map.
317. 15–22 min — Clarify Viṣṇu/Kṛṣṇa-centered object and the difference between devotional form and generic virtue.
318. 22–30 min — Family routine audit: mark strong, occasional and absent processes without public scoring.
319. 30–35 min — Case: one-process pride, activity without hearing and study without service.
320. 35–40 min — Create a seven-day bhakti menu with one core practice and one underused process only.

Children's Parallel Lesson — 40 Minutes

Common child timing: 0–5 opening/recall; 5–15 story or text; 15–28 movement, art, game or investigation; 28–35 verse/recall; 35–40 cleanup and family transition.

Age 4-6

- Nine-process action circle with picture icons and simple gestures.
- Prahlāda story focus: he remembers and speaks about Kṛṣṇa.
- Choose a favorite process picture and perform one safe action.
- Make a nine-petal flower craft with adult help.

Age 7-9

- Match nine processes with famous examples from the purport at recognition level.
- Bhakti charades using only respectful actions.
- Design a three-item family bhakti menu.
- Practice the first line of the verse by rhythm and gesture.

Age 10-13

- Read ŚB 7.5.23–24 and categorize processes as receiving, expressing, serving and relating while noting overlap.
- Analyze why a process needs Kṛṣṇa-centered object and intention.
- Discuss one-process perfection without using it as an excuse to avoid other duties.
- Take responsibility for one trained service in the integration week.

Analogy and Practical Example

Analogy	Practical family example
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- The nine processes are a bhakti menu or tool set: families may have strengths, but the map prevents devotion from shrinking to one weekly class or one public talent.

- A family already chants briefly but rarely serves. Rather than increasing chanting targets immediately, they maintain the chant and add ten minutes of book care or prasāda cleanup together on Sunday.

Questions: Discovery, Understanding and Application

Discovery

- What are the nine processes named by Prahāda?
- Which processes already appear in the Friday program?
- What does the purport say about one process practiced without deviation?

Understanding

- Why is bhakti more than generic kindness or cultural activity?
- How can different processes strengthen one another?
- Why should different family strengths not become rankings?

Application

- Which process is strongest in your family?
- Which important process is underused?
- What one small action will add it without overload?

Bhakti Laboratory — Nine-Process Bhakti Stations

321. Set up brief stations: hear a verse, respond in kīrtana, remember a quality, clean a sacred space, observe approved worship items, write a prayer, complete a service, make a friendship promise to Kṛṣṇa and place a plan before Kṛṣṇa.
322. Exact worship actions are demonstration-only unless approved and trained.
323. Families rotate in small groups; each station lasts two minutes.
324. At the end, each person chooses one process that felt natural and one to learn.

Competency check

Participant recognizes all nine processes and completes at least three age-appropriate examples respectfully.

Family Home Practice

Field	Detail
Minimum	Continue the family's core practice and add one underused process once.
Standard	Use the seven-day bhakti menu on three days.
Stretch	Assign one age-appropriate family service linked to the chosen process.
Evidence	Private menu check; no comparison of quantity or complexity.

Slide Outline

325. When bhakti becomes too narrow
326. Prahāda's nine processes
327. Hearing, chanting and remembering
328. Service, worship and prayer
329. Servitorship, friendship and surrender
330. One process can be complete
331. Different strengths, no ranking
332. Family bhakti menu
333. One added process

Teacher Preparation

- Read ŚB 7.5.23–24 and purport carefully; prepare the traditional example names only if teachers can present them accurately.
- Coordinate station content with the worship lead so no unapproved procedure is taught.
- Prepare icons and short age-appropriate actions for all nine processes.
- Avoid overloading families with nine home commitments.
- Brief teachers that personality preference is not the sole authority for selecting practice.

Required Materials

Materials A • Nine-process icons • Wall map • Station signs • Verse audio or reader • Prayer cards	Materials B • Cleaning cloths • Approved worship display • Bhakti menu sheets • Craft supplies • Timer
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Assessment

- Adult recognizes all nine processes and explains at least four accurately.
- Family identifies one underused process and a realistic action.
- Child matches at least five icons; younger children may demonstrate through gestures.
- Teacher checks that worship and surrender language remain within authorized, age-appropriate bounds.

Newcomer Adaptation

KUTUMBA Setu application

Provide a nine-process picture card. New families may join stations and choose hearing or chanting as the default home practice until Setu is complete.

Risks and Sensitive Points

- Do not turn the nine processes into a public completion checklist.
- Do not teach unapproved Deity-worship procedures at the arcana station.
- Do not pressure surrender language in ways that weaken personal safety or boundaries.
- Do not rank visible services above quiet hearing, prayer or remembrance.

Printable Worksheet — C3-W5

The Nine Processes of Bhakti

Key verse and memory line

Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 7.5.23–24

Hearing, chanting, remembering, serving, worshiping, praying, serving as a servant, friendship and full surrender are processes of pure devotional service.

List or match the nine processes: _____.

Our strongest process: _____. Evidence: _____.

Our underused process: _____.

One small action to add it: _____.

What we will keep unchanged to avoid overload: _____.

Child box: Circle one process you enjoy and star one you want to learn.

This Week's Saṅkalpa

Specific action: _____

Day/time and trigger: _____

Minimum version: _____

How we will review it: _____

C3-W6 — Bhakti Mela: Kīrtana, Drama and Family Presentation

Cycle 3 — Kṛṣṇa, Guru and the Process of Bhakti

Field	Detail
Week code	C3-W6
Cycle function	Integration, presentation, drama, quiz and service
Purpose	Integrate the first six months by demonstrating who Kṛṣṇa is, how knowledge is received and how the nine processes become family life, then establish a simple continuing practice before the next curriculum phase.
Key verse	Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 7.5.23–24 — iti puṁsārpitā viṣṇau bhaktiś cen nava-lakṣaṇā
Memory line	These processes become pure devotional service when offered to Viṣṇu with one's life and intention.
Bhakti laboratory	Bhakti Mela Rotation and Thirty-Day Baseline
Minimum home practice	Begin the thirty-day baseline with the smallest daily practice.

Learning Outcomes

Outcome domain	By the end of the session, participants should be able to...
Knowledge	- Connect God's peace formula, Kṛṣṇa's supreme position, guru-sādhū-śāstra, the holy name and the nine processes. - Recall the cycle's core sources at recognition level.
Skill	- Present one source-based principle through kīrtana, drama, poster, demonstration or explanation. - Participate in organized service and give appreciation without comparison.
Practice	Create a thirty-day family bhakti baseline with one daily, one weekly and one monthly element.
Character	Joyful service, cooperation, humility, reliability and gratitude.
Child	- Contribute through a safe role suited to age and comfort. - Identify one way their family will continue hearing, chanting or serving.

Primary Śrīla Prabhupāda Sources

- Review: Bhagavad-gītā 5.29
- Review: Bhagavad-gītā 7.7 and 10.8
- Review: Bhagavad-gītā 4.34
- Review: Caitanya-caritāmṛta Antya 20.12
- Review: Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 7.5.23–24

Key verse

Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 7.5.23–24
iti puṁsārpitā viṣṇau bhaktiś cen nava-lakṣaṇā

Teaching memory line: These processes become pure devotional service when offered to Viṣṇu with one's life and intention.

Prem-kī-Kathā Script

Delivery target: 8–10 minutes of scripted narration plus 5–7 minutes of interaction. Do not exceed the 20-minute block.

Six months ago, KUTUMBA began with a question: Why are we here? The answer was not to create another event. We came to help families hear, chant, remember, serve and reorganize home life around Kṛṣṇa.

The first cycle taught identity. We are not merely changing bodies; we are eternal souls. Human life is valuable, and temporary arrangements cannot permanently satisfy the soul. The second cycle taught responsibility. Actions have reactions, choices matter within conditioning, consciousness continues, the modes influence us and *māyā* is crossed through surrender. The third cycle has brought the positive center into focus: Kṛṣṇa is the proprietor, enjoyer and friend; He is the Supreme Personality of Godhead; knowledge comes through guru, *sādhū* and *śāstra*; Lord Caitanya gives the holy name; and *bhakti* engages the whole life through nine processes.

A festival can make these truths visible. *Kīrtana* engages hearing and chanting. Drama helps remembrance. Preparing the space is service. Prayer brings the heart. Caring for Kṛṣṇa's items is worship and stewardship. Cooperation can express friendship and servitorship. Offering the family plan to Kṛṣṇa begins surrender.

But a mela can also become a performance. One child receives applause, one family creates the best display and one musician controls the evening. That would contradict the curriculum. Tonight every contribution is service. The measure is accuracy, sincerity, cooperation and usefulness—not talent.

The closing task is not a grand vow. Each family will create a thirty-day baseline: one tiny daily practice, one weekly family practice and one monthly service or temple connection. It should survive work pressure, sickness and travel through a minimum version.

Kṛṣṇa consciousness grows when philosophy, practice, character and relationship support one another. The first six months are a foundation, not completion. We offer what has grown, correct what remains weak and take the next truthful step together.

Parent Lesson — 40 Minutes

- 334. 0–5 min — State mela rules: service, source accuracy, time limits, no ranking and child opt-out roles.
- 335. 5–25 min — Family presentations in rotating zones: source poster, short drama, *kīrtana* role, nine-process demonstration or stewardship exhibit.
- 336. 25–31 min — Guru-*sādhū*-*śāstra* source check quiz using teams but no public score.
- 337. 31–36 min — Six-month learning chain reflection: identity, responsibility and relationship with Kṛṣṇa.
- 338. 36–40 min — Draft the thirty-day baseline and identify mentor support if needed.

Children's Parallel Lesson — 40 Minutes

Common child timing: 0–5 opening/recall; 5–15 story or text; 15–28 movement, art, game or investigation; 28–35 verse/recall; 35–40 cleanup and family transition.

Age 4-6

- Join a short procession of nine-process icons.
- Participate in two simple call-and-response mantras.
- Act one safe role in a brief Govardhana or 'family garden' drama.
- Place a sticker on daily, weekly and monthly family practice pictures.

Age 7-9

- Present a nine-process petal, verse picture or Kṛṣṇa-quality card.
- Complete a source-and-analogy treasure trail.
- Serve in welcome, materials or cleanup with adult oversight.
- Help create the thirty-day family baseline poster.

Age 10-13

- Lead one supervised station, two-minute *kīrtana* segment or source-based explanation.
- Perform a misconception-repair drama involving guru authority, mode labels or *kīrtana* competition.
- Assist younger children without taking responsibility for discipline or safety.
- Write a personal service intention aligned with the family baseline.

Analogy and Practical Example

Analogy	Practical family example
• The six-month curriculum is a house foundation: identity is the footing, responsible practice is the structure and relationship with Kṛṣṇa is the living center; decoration without	• A family's baseline is: daily—three mahā-mantras before school; weekly—one fifteen-minute Sunday reading; monthly—one temple or community service. During illness,

foundation will not hold.

the daily minimum is one mantra and the weekly minimum is one paragraph.

Questions: Discovery, Understanding and Application

Discovery

- Which principle from each cycle changed your understanding most?
- Which source can you now locate and explain?
- Which home practice was most sustainable?

Understanding

- How do identity, responsibility and relationship with Kṛṣṇa depend on one another?
- Why must source authority and safety remain part of joyful bhakti?
- Why is a small baseline stronger than an impressive temporary vow?

Application

- What will your family do daily, weekly and monthly?
- What is the minimum version during disruption?
- What support is needed, and what remains the family's own responsibility?

Bhakti Laboratory — Bhakti Mela Rotation and Thirty-Day Baseline

339. Zone A: attentive kīrtana and response.
340. Zone B: authorized Kṛṣṇa-kathā or drama.
341. Zone C: guru-sādhū-śāstra source verification.
342. Zone D: nine-process service demonstration.
343. Zone E: family baseline planning with daily, weekly, monthly and minimum versions.
344. Close with appreciation and collective prayer, not awards.

Competency check

Family demonstrates source-based understanding, one practical bhakti skill and a realistic continuing baseline.

Family Home Practice

Field	Detail
Minimum	Begin the thirty-day baseline with the smallest daily practice.
Standard	Complete the daily and weekly elements for four weeks and one monthly service/temple connection.
Stretch	Hold one family review at day fifteen and adjust the plan without adding more than one element.
Evidence	Private family tracker; mentor sees only what the family chooses to share unless a safety issue exists.

Slide Outline

345. Bhakti Mela: service, not competition
346. Six-month learning chain
347. Zone map and timing
348. Source check
349. Kīrtana and drama
350. Nine processes in family life
351. What KUTUMBA does not replace
352. Thirty-day baseline
353. Gratitude and next phase

Teacher Preparation

- Collect presentation choices two weeks ahead and impose strict preparation caps.

- Review every script, slide and song for source accuracy and age suitability.
- Confirm kīrtana, worship, child-safety, food and room-flow responsibilities.
- Prepare private assessment rubrics and baseline planning cards.
- Do not add certificates implying formal qualification, initiation readiness or Bhakti Śāstrī credit.

Required Materials

Materials A • Zone signs • Approved instruments • Presentation tables • Source cards • Drama props	Materials B • Nine-process icons • Baseline planners • Private rubrics • Timers • Appreciation cards
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Assessment

- Use four domains: source accuracy, practical demonstration, cooperation and realistic continuity plan.
- Families receive private feedback: established, developing or next support needed.
- Children can use non-speaking roles; artistic quality is not assessed.
- No completion certificate should imply accreditation or spiritual qualification.

Newcomer Adaptation

KUTUMBA Setu application

Observers may attend the mela and join general kīrtana or stations, but do not receive completion status. Offer Setu enrollment and entry at the next cycle boundary.

Risks and Sensitive Points

- The mela can become a performance or family comparison event; enforce service framing.
- Do not imply six-month completion equals initiation readiness or Bhakti Śāstrī preparation completion.
- Do not overload families with the thirty-day baseline.
- Review every child role for consent, safety and developmental fit.

Printable Worksheet — C3-W6

Bhakti Mela: Kīrtana, Drama and Family Presentation

Key verse and memory line

Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 7.5.23–24

These processes become pure devotional service when offered to Viṣṇu with one's life and intention.

Our strongest six-month insight: _____.

A misconception we corrected: _____.

Daily practice: _____. Minimum version: _____.

Weekly practice: _____. Minimum version: _____.

Monthly service or temple connection: _____.

Likely obstacle: _____. Support/adjustment: _____.

One appreciation for another family: _____.

This Week's Saṅkalpa

Specific action: _____

Day/time and trigger: _____

Minimum version: _____

How we will review it: _____

Appendix A — Teacher Preparation Rhythm

Field	Detail
7 days before	Read assigned primary sources; identify one principle, one misconception and one practical method. Confirm safety and worship review needs.
4–5 days before	Prepare slides, worksheet, materials and child-band adaptations. Submit any new scriptural claim or worship procedure for review.
48 hours before	Confirm headcount, child bands, two-adult coverage, room layout, allergy information and equipment.
Friday before arrival	Test slides/audio, arrange materials, remove unsafe items, brief volunteers and protect transition routes.
After session	Record attendance separately from curriculum files, capture misconceptions and operational defects, and revise the master lesson through version control.

Appendix B — Universal Facilitation Rules

- No uninterrupted adult teaching segment longer than ten minutes without a question, text observation, pair task or case.
- Ask discovery questions before giving interpretation; ask application questions only after the principle is clear.
- Never demand emotional disclosure. Participants may pass, write privately or use a fictional case.
- Correct philosophy calmly and specifically. Do not shame a participant or child in front of the group.
- Do not diagnose karma, spiritual level, family problems, mental illness or guru qualification.
- Use “I do not know; I will verify” whenever the source or policy is uncertain.
- Children remain under designated trained adult supervision in visible spaces; parents remain responsible for their children.
- Outings, festival programs and integration nights replace the normal weekly program rather than adding another burden.

Appendix C — Private Assessment Rubric

Domain	Demonstrated	Developing	Needs support
Knowledge	States the principle accurately and cites/recognizes the source.	Understands the direction but mixes terms or needs prompts.	Major misconception, speculation or inability to identify the principle.
Skill	Completes the case, question or laboratory method independently or with normal family support.	Completes with coaching or partial steps.	Cannot yet perform safely or accurately.
Practice	Chooses a specific, realistic commitment with a minimum version.	Commitment is vague, overlarge or depends on reminders.	No practical plan or unsafe/unrealistic plan.
Character	Shows respect, honesty, cooperation and non-comparison.	Generally respectful but needs reminders.	Repeated shaming, domination, gossip, comparison or refusal of safety rules.

Appendix D — Newcomer Bridge Within a Live Session

354. Welcome without public interrogation; provide the one-page cycle map and glossary.
355. Pair the family with a mentor family who explains only the minimum prerequisite concepts.
356. Allow observation or simplified participation; do not restart the full group lesson.
357. Assign the minimum home practice only and avoid immediate service responsibility.
358. At the next cycle boundary, confirm completion of KUTUMBA Setu before full participation.

Appendix E — Master Sensitive-Topic Guardrails

- Body and soul: never dismiss health, disability, abuse, emotions or bodily safety.

- Human life: avoid death anxiety, species contempt and adult standards imposed on children.
- Temporary world: do not trivialize grief, poverty, illness or family affection.
- Karma: never identify a specific cause for another person's suffering; reject victim-blaming.
- Free will: do not imply victims chose harm or that conditioning removes all responsibility.
- Reincarnation: no predictions, ghost stories or fear-based control.
- Modes: never label people, genders, cultures, diagnoses or families as a mode.
- Māyā: women are not māyā; material responsibility is not condemned.
- God and Kṛṣṇa: teach clear siddhānta without mocking other traditions or devas.
- Guru: no pressure toward a guru or initiation; respect never overrides safeguarding and accountability.
- Holy name: no performance ranking or imitation of advanced symptoms.
- Bhakti processes: no checklist competition and no unapproved worship procedure.

Appendix F — Primary Source Index by Week

Week	Key verse	Primary sources
C1-W1	Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.2.18	Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.2.17–21, especially 1.2.18; Bhagavad-gītā 9.14; Caitanya-caritāmṛta Madhya 22.128–129 (five powerful practices of bhakti); KUTUMBA Master Operating Model: identity, six charter purposes and Friday flow
C1-W2	Bhagavad-gītā 2.13	Bhagavad-gītā 2.13; Bhagavad-gītā 2.16–18; Bhagavad-gītā 13.1–3; Śrīla Prabhupāda lectures and purports on dehī and deha as reflected in the assigned verses
C1-W3	Bhagavad-gītā 2.20	Bhagavad-gītā 2.17–25, especially 2.20; Bhagavad-gītā 15.7; Bhagavad-gītā 13.23 (distinguishing the Supersoul); Śrīla Prabhupāda's purport to Bhagavad-gītā 2.20
C1-W4	Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.9.29	Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.9.29; Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 7.6.1; Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.2.10; Bhagavad-gītā 7.19
C1-W5	Bhagavad-gītā 8.15	Bhagavad-gītā 2.14; Bhagavad-gītā 5.22; Bhagavad-gītā 8.15; Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.2.10; Bhagavad-gītā 9.27
C1-W6	Bhagavad-gītā 2.13	Review: Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.2.18; Review: Bhagavad-gītā 2.13 and 2.20; Review: Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.9.29; Review: Bhagavad-gītā 8.15 and 9.27
C2-W1	Bhagavad-gītā 3.9	Bhagavad-gītā 3.9; Bhagavad-gītā 4.16–18; Bhagavad-gītā 3.13; Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Chapter 64 (King Nrga), used selectively and age-appropriately
C2-W2	Bhagavad-gītā 18.63	Bhagavad-gītā 18.61–63, especially 18.63; Bhagavad-gītā 3.33–34; Bhagavad-gītā 5.14–15; Bhagavad-gītā 2.7 and 18.73 (Arjuna seeks guidance and chooses)
C2-W3	Bhagavad-gītā 2.22	Bhagavad-gītā 2.13; Bhagavad-gītā 2.20 and 2.22; Bhagavad-gītā 2.27; Bhagavad-gītā 8.5–6; Bhagavad-gītā 14.14–15, introduced only at recognition level
C2-W4	Bhagavad-gītā 14.5	Bhagavad-gītā 14.5–9; Bhagavad-gītā 14.17–18; Bhagavad-gītā 17.8–10, used carefully for general food tendencies rather than policing families; Bhagavad-gītā 14.26
C2-W5	Bhagavad-gītā 7.14	Bhagavad-gītā 7.14; Bhagavad-gītā 2.62–63; Bhagavad-gītā 15.7; Bhagavad-gītā 9.10; Śrīla Prabhupāda's recurring 'decorating the prison cell' analogy, used as an analogy rather than a direct quotation exercise

Week	Key verse	Primary sources
C2-W6	Bhagavad-gītā 18.63	Review: Bhagavad-gītā 3.9; Review: Bhagavad-gītā 18.63; Review: Bhagavad-gītā 2.22; Review: Bhagavad-gītā 14.5; Review: Bhagavad-gītā 7.14
C3-W1	Bhagavad-gītā 5.29	Bhagavad-gītā 5.29; Bhagavad-gītā 9.10; Bhagavad-gītā 13.23; Śrī Īsopaniṣad Invocation and Mantra 1; Bhagavad-gītā 9.26
C3-W2	Bhagavad-gītā 7.7	Bhagavad-gītā 7.7; Bhagavad-gītā 10.8; Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.3.28; Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Introduction; Kṛṣṇa Book chapters on Govardhana-līlā and Brahmā's prayers, selected according to age
C3-W3	Bhagavad-gītā 4.34	Bhagavad-gītā 4.34; Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.3.21; Caitanya-caritāmṛta Madhya 20.122; Bhagavad-gītā 2.7; KUTUMBA source-authority and temple-relationship policies
C3-W4	Caitanya-caritāmṛta Antya 20.12 — Śikṣāṣṭakam 1	Caitanya-caritāmṛta Antya 20.12 (Śikṣāṣṭakam 1); Caitanya-caritāmṛta Ādi 7.163; Caitanya-caritāmṛta Ādi 17.21; Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 12.3.51; Śrīla Prabhupāda's standard teaching and practice of the Hare Kṛṣṇa mahā-mantra
C3-W5	Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 7.5.23–24	Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 7.5.23–24; Bhagavad-gītā 9.14; Caitanya-caritāmṛta Madhya 22.128–129; Selected examples from Śrīla Prabhupāda's purport to ŚB 7.5.23–24
C3-W6	Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 7.5.23–24	Review: Bhagavad-gītā 5.29; Review: Bhagavad-gītā 7.7 and 10.8; Review: Bhagavad-gītā 4.34; Review: Caitanya-caritāmṛta Antya 20.12; Review: Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 7.5.23–24

Appendix G — Version-Control Record

Field	Detail
Document	KUTUMBA First Six-Month Detailed Curriculum
Version	v0.9 working draft
Scope	Cycles 1–3; 18 active weeks plus three protected off weeks
Source architecture	KUTUMBA Master Operating Model and dedicated curriculum workstream
Required reviewers	Curriculum/Philosophy, Children/Safety, Kīrtana/Worship, Temple Liaison and qualified ISKCON authority where needed
Change rule	All doctrinal, worship, safety or policy corrections must be incorporated into the version-controlled master before reuse.